MyScoutee

MYSCOUTEE TRILOGY

II

PART TWO
OF THE TRILOGY

The Story

Part II — The System Between Us



A founder's memoir of rules, laughter, and the price of becoming legible

PUBLIC EDITION V1.0.0 · PUBLISHED 12 AUGUST 2026

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A first-person public memoir of an unresolved legal and institutional period. Documentary record, attributed recollection, memoir and later public context remain explicitly distinct.

For the Hungarians who,
in one way or another, had to
leave home.

My story is theirs, too.

Contents

A Note to the Reader

Prologue — The Other Biography

PART ONE — THE LEGAL DOOR

1. The Year That Opened
2. A Distorted Choice Can Still Be Legal
3. Protecting a Handover

PART TWO — THREE PEOPLE, NO SHARED SCREEN

4. The Low-Trust Triangle
5. The Password That Was Not a Relationship
6. Three Attempts at a Subtraction
7. The First Public-Interest Proposal

PART THREE — THE SENTENCE AND THE BODY

8. Saturday Before Dawn
9. The Correction Does Not Trend
10. A Body With a Deadline

PART FOUR — WHEN A PERSON BECOMES EVIDENCE

11. The Knock One Year Later
12. Remarks in the Margin
13. The Man the Report Invented
14. Defence by Accumulation

PART FIVE — WORK UNDER THE SHADOW

15. The Work the File Could Not Explain
16. The House as a Human Archive
17. Beautiful Cities Can Still Produce Exits
18. The Breaking Point Is Not the Beginning

PART SIX — A PRIVATE CASE ENTERS PUBLIC TIME

19. The Streets Begin to Speak
20. The Programme Hidden Inside the Complaint
21. Four Years Later
22. Two Letters to Venice
23. When an Eighth Judge Steps Aside
24. The Convoy and the List of Offices
25. The Empty Presidential Chair

PART SEVEN — THE SYSTEM WE BUILD INSTEAD

26. The Product Returns
27. Humour Is a Human Audit Trail
28. The Invitation Changes

NOTES ON EVIDENCE, CONTEXT, AND THE OPEN ENDING

How to use these notes

The primary record

The 2019–2021 employment thresholds

Legal reference map

Clemency social inquiry

KATA

Formal rules and lived practice

Interpersonal trust, hierarchy and the remote team

Civic and judicial context

Emergency powers and public reversals

Long-term work exclusion

The 2026 transition

The Ukrainian cash-in-transit affair and institutional departures

The Venice Commission

Foreign-currency loans and migration

AI-assisted work and the Navier–Stokes exchange

Part III boundary

A Note to the Reader

This is a memoir of an unresolved period.

Part I ended with an invitation. I had returned from London, travelled, looked for a partner, and spent the independence I had built on a product that might help people reach one another more humanely. The last pages moved through a Hungarian multinational role, COVID-19, and a cross-border remote opportunity. The sentence at the threshold was simple: *what followed belongs to Part II.*

What followed survives as contracts, portal records, calls, police papers, petitions and public events. It also survives as rooms: the bedroom where my leg was raised above me, the ordinary police office, the smaller room where counsel asked for time, the C-shaped court table, and the desk where a cursor in an artificial intelligence (AI) assistant kept blinking beside the possibility of prison.

Public history usually arrives as laws, elections, resignations and dates. A person receives it differently. A law becomes a cancelled contract. A digital design becomes a password handed across a desk. An institutional failure becomes a night without sleep, then a sentence, then a knock at the door. This book follows that smaller route through the larger period. The personal story does not replace the history. It is where the history becomes measurable in a human life.

The central absurdity can be stated without legal vocabulary. A sudden law put livelihoods under threat. The accountant, the tax administration and I each passed responsibility toward the next point in a chain whose legal burden never left me. When I finally saw the whole failure, I understood in about a week what the professional process had not resolved over several months. I corrected the return, paid the tax and ended the failed representation. The return had been corrected and the tax liability resolved. Roughly a year later, eight days after the police search, the forensic process examined the highly educated professional who had repaired the failure and turned him into the subject of a label of pathological mental illness.

After two decades of exclusion, adaptation and repeated attempts to build a lawful life in my own country, one sentence broke loose under accumulated pressure. I corrected it immediately and kept writing. Its wording remains part of the record. So does the repaired return, the paid tax, the ended representation, the written

administrative history and the request for peace around surgery. The state later allowed the sentence and later messages to travel farther than those repairs. A system cannot preserve the breaking point, discard the path around it and then use the surviving fragment to prove that the person had always been the problem.

Nearly four years after the work stopped, and nearly three years into the criminal proceeding, the case had not produced a first-instance judgment, let alone reached an appeal. Minutes of language had expanded across years of life. A sentence born inside one badly assembled sequence was already consuming years; if every remaining stage moved at the same pace, the process itself could take a decade before anyone reached its end.

The proceeding has not reached the ending reserved for Part III. The factual record, attribution limits and source references appear at the back, where they can protect accuracy without interrupting every scene.

All character and scene illustrations in this book are AI-generated visual interpretations. They do not depict the actual participants.

That matters because the pattern is not mine alone. Another person might never write my sentences and could still enter the same corridor.

The corridor was not evidence of a defective nation, and not every Hungarian office or official behaved alike. It belonged to a low-trust culture many of us learn to navigate before anybody names it. The written rule points one way. The workable custom points another. Authority travels upward, responsibility travels downward, and the citizen is expected to know both routes without ever confusing them in public.

You smell that culture before you can define it. Everybody in the room knows a process is broken, yet each person protects the narrow role that lets the failure become somebody else's problem. A smile acknowledges the absurdity and the procedure continues. A password is personal when responsibility is being assigned and shareable when work needs to be done. The correction disappears. The outburst remains.

Hundreds of thousands of Hungarians did not leave the country for one reason. They left for wages, housing, work, love, language, adventure and dignity in different proportions. This book follows one less visible pressure among them: the exhaustion of living where informal adaptation is required to make formal institutions work, yet the individual alone can be punished when that adaptation fails.

Prologue — The Other Biography

Part I required a book to describe one person.

He came from agricultural ground and studied economics, programming and mathematics. He learned English through work in southern India, worked across continents, lived for five years in London and organized journeys through nearly fifty countries. Those journeys depended on strangers: a driver, a passenger, a hotel worker, a colleague, a couple sharing a taxi, somebody who noticed that the road ahead was unsafe. He saved through a shared bedroom and lunches he pretended not to need, then returned to Budapest with enough independence to build software intended to help people trust one another long enough to meet.

Part I was built from those meetings because human relationships cannot be cancelled out of the equation of a life. The driver, roommate, colleague, stranger, date and family member were not decorative anecdotes around the “real” biography. They were the forces through which decisions became possible, fear became bearable and a place became home.

Part I asked what a first judgment can erase between two people. Part II follows the same act after it acquires institutional force. A profile can end a conversation before a meeting becomes real. A label can begin to rewrite a life. In both cases, the shock lands inside the person being reduced, and what follows may be far larger than the thin first frame.

MyScoutee began with the gentler version of that problem. It tried to loosen the natural first distrust between strangers just enough for shared context to form before judgment became final. The system in Part II repeatedly lacked that capacity to receive the person it was classifying.

A forensic report later created another biography in a few paragraphs.

It described a man living through a fixed “global conspiracy,” incapable of positive feeling in human relationships, inclined to treat helpfulness as proof of bad intent, and driven by inferiority, projection and severe paranoid personality

disorder. The report said this condition reached the level of pathological mental illness and moderately limited his capacity to recognize the consequences of his actions.

The same report recorded that he was calm and cooperative, understood the examination, observed ordinary forms of courtesy, was oriented in every respect and had intact comprehension, memory and intellect appropriate to his education. It found no earlier psychiatric documentation, no perceptual disturbance and no formal disorder of thought.

Quietness had always made people expect compliance from me. I was not quick-tempered; years could pass without anger reaching my voice. When it finally did, the sudden force could silence a room precisely because nobody had seen it coming. The file received the rare voice without the long quiet around it.

Both biographies carried my name.

Writing them together required a third position. I had to step outside my own fear and treat myself as one participant in the chain: not the innocent centre of every event, not the clinical character in the report, but a person whose actions could be examined beside everybody else's. That distance did not come from having too few attachments. It was necessary because there were too many. Every room led back to parents, colleagues, housemates, strangers, clients, officials and the country I had tried to make home. From inside all those bonds, the story was almost impossible to write. From slightly outside myself, its structure became visible.

A passport cannot settle a psychiatric question. It can expose the thinness of a caricature. My journeys had worked precisely because I could recognize help, trust unfamiliar people provisionally, revise a plan and experience warmth across languages. My software existed because I still believed human connection could be designed for without being controlled.

The security concern recorded by the experts was equally concrete. I objected to a system in which a personal government-account password could become the practical substitute for safe delegation, exposing taxpayers and accountants to actions performed under the wrong identity. The report preserved that argument, called my account contradictory and later translated the wider pattern into a “global conspiracy.”

This is not the story of an ordinary tax offence. Nor is it a legal brief with illustrations. It is the story of how the first biography was compressed until the second could fit the file—and how a period in the history of a country can be seen through that act of compression.

The compression began with a line on a screen. At the end of Part I, that line was a network connecting strangers. Here it became the ruled line of a form: a number, a date, a legal category, a signature. A home became an office. The office became a tax desk. The desk became a police scene. Eight days after the search, the police scene became a forensic examination. The resulting report was signed weeks later, but the transformation had already begun.

I had never been a party activist. When KATA (itemised tax for small businesses) changed in July 2022, others went to the bridges. I stayed at my computer and tried to protect a Belgian handover. I did not set out to confront a state. I tried to finish a piece of work, close a tax form and prepare for an operation.

That ordinary sequence matters. Kafka does not begin when a frightened man writes an extraordinary sentence. Kafka begins when everybody is performing an ordinary duty and the duties no longer meet: a government changes a route, a client still needs delivery, an accountant submits, a portal rejects, an official redirects, a taxpayer repairs, and a later institution reads only the sentence produced when the disconnected pieces fell onto one person.

That is where the irony begins.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part One — The Legal Door



1. The Year That Opened

The man who returned from London did not return because London had defeated him. He returned because the arithmetic had finally changed.



The same person, now carrying a different system.

Five years of shared rooms, restrained spending and foreign work had produced financial independence at Budapest prices. It was not wealth in London. In the flat my parents had helped provide, it was time: time to recover, travel, search for a partner and attempt the product that employment had never left enough space to build. Living with little had become a discipline. I believed that if I could remain independent of the next salary, I could endure almost anything.

By early 2019, I was searching for work again. Roughly fifty interviews failed. By August, I was close to returning to London when a multinational company hired me in Hungary almost by accident. Getting there contained its own small comedy. A local outsourcing company had first offered to place me at the multinational only if I became a sole proprietor and invoiced through KATA. I rejected the whole entrepreneurial arrangement, not merely that tax category. I wanted a salaried job, not to be turned into a business for somebody else's convenience. The smaller company judged my interview unsuccessful and wrote me off professionally.

Two weeks later, the multinational invited me into its own salaried process. The interviewers had not compared notes. When the earlier rejection surfaced in the second round, the room hesitated; then the company hired me directly, as an employee, for roughly twice the money. One accidental gap between institutions opened the stable door I had been trying to find.

KATA contractors at the same workplace still cost less than employees. Once I was inside, the apparently stable foothold became strangely hollow. I had very little work. I suspected that the smaller company's bad assessment had followed me as office gossip, but I never saw proof. A product manager repeatedly routed work to other teams. I spent long days in the office performing availability.

When I finally tired of waiting, I was placed alone between a German programme and a Hungarian organization. A single shared storefront was supposed to join ten national subsidiaries. The interface was singular; the marketing strategies were not. The Hungarian office's money came through its own marketing. On German calls, I presented a common shop whose countries had not agreed on one counter.

After almost a year, I finally said aloud that I had scarcely been given work. The sentence travelled—up toward German leadership, back toward Hungarian management, or both; I could not see the complete route. I entered the offices of several senior executives. Their questions made clear that the empty year was new to them. Then COVID-19 restructuring arrived, and my name was selected. I could not see whether one event had pushed the other. After months spent representing work that had nowhere to land, I was the part declared surplus.

That dismissal felt like a tragedy. The ending itself was more humane than the year before it. I argued about the terms and negotiated a stronger severance payment than people around me expected. Their surprise briefly made the bargain feel like an achievement. It did not make the closed door smaller. I had spent years trying to enter stable employment; when I finally reached it, I lost the job before the job had properly found me.

COVID-19 made the next door difficult to find. One process at another multinational reached a fourth round. A former supervisor entered the conversation because he knew one of the leaders. He had not known the smaller-company prehistory and had not seen what the almost empty year looked like from my desk. I believed his intervention helped close the door, but I never saw the decision being made. No offer arrived.

The next salaried door opened at an investment bank in January 2021, while Hungary was under an evening curfew. In the office, faces had been reduced to eyes above masks. The bank required a long assessment and would not let me start until an outsourced background check returned. That check asked me to move identity documents through email and screening channels I considered old and weakly authenticated. The route took weeks and a large bundle of personal material. By the time it cleared, its awkwardness had become comedy. On my first day, I compared the handling of my data to *Monty Python*. The manager warned that this attitude could cost me the job. The screening had cleared. Trust had not.

At the end of the first week, compliance training revealed another gate. The bank's many employee-trading rules required approval around transactions in the retail Hungarian government bonds that held most of my savings. On one screen, the bond was household saving. On another, it was a controlled trade. These bonds were not an experiment for me. They were the seven-year floor beneath my independence.

The third week ended in a small masked theatre. The manager's anger was visible above the mask. Two solidly built colleagues sat smiling on either side of me while the termination papers landed on the table. A three-week employer stood on one side of the decision; seven years of security stood on the other. I chose the seven.

The previous dismissal had felt like a future being taken away. By the time I reached this room, I was already burned out. Nothing in the papers caught. On the way to the exit, I asked whether I could finally buy government bonds again. The dismissal passed through me. It did not matter.

An internal ethics review followed. For roughly three hours, I spoke with the bank's local lawyers. One question kept returning: had the manager threatened me? I said no. It was a cleaner answer than the memory. I had heard the warning on the first day and had chosen not to give it that name. I would not describe my answer as complete now. The institution received one word; I carried the rest of the scene out with me.

That masked room became my last Hungarian workplace. Almost six years later, it remains so. I did not know at the exit that I was leaving more than one building.

A year and a half separated that background check from the KATA change. The screening had been a gate I managed to pass. The later proceeding threatened to turn the lawful route back into work into the kind of record that could close such gates in the future.

During the next search, I first refused a Brussels project connected to a European institution. The contract placed too much risk on me, and I still believed I could find another salaried door. Eight months and dozens of interviews later, that belief had run out before my wish to work did.

The opportunity that finally held was a multinational telecom programme connected to Brussels. In ordinary times, it would probably have required me to leave Hungary again. During COVID-19, I did not dare fly into another relocation. Remote work made the geography temporarily negotiable: I could remain in my Budapest flat while working abroad. The contractual route passed through companies in more than one country. It looked less secure than the Hungarian job, but in practice it became the one workable professional path I had found.

The work gathered speed before I had arranged the life around it. I was already inside long Brussels calls, moving tasks from one person to the next, before I had an accountant. Between deliveries, I was still looking for the professional who would later handle the returns. The opening had arrived, and I stepped into it.

Stable work was never only income. Without it, partnership, a child and family life remained plans postponed until the ground stopped moving. By then, the years no longer felt renewable. The Brussels role arrived as the last opening through which work and the rest of life might still begin together.

I accepted it because independence was not meant to become permanent retreat. After years outside ordinary employment, I still wanted to work, contribute and belong to the country in which I lived. That decision matters later. The system did

not reach me because I had avoided lawful work. It reached me immediately after I dared to enter it again through the only route that had opened.

It also required a legal form through which the work could be invoiced. Just over two years after I had rejected becoming an entrepreneur as the price of a domestic placement, I accepted it as the last available route into work. In September 2021, I became a sole proprietor using KATA.

I had no entrepreneurial revelation. I was not opening a café, selling paintings or building a personal brand. Informal foreign work might have left me outside the system's view. I chose the legal door instead. KATA was the bridge between a foreign job and the country in which I was still trying to live. The bridge existed because the pandemic had made another departure feel impossible.

That distinction matters. A tax form can look like a free choice after the fact while functioning as the price of entry at the time. Years of exclusion and unsuccessful job searches came first. Then one Hungarian employer happened to give me a foothold in 2019. COVID-19 broke it. Another attempt failed. The work I could finally secure was in Belgium and, without the pandemic, would have pulled me abroad again. I did not dare fly into another relocation during COVID-19, so I worked remotely from Budapest and used KATA as the legal bridge.

Every piece of that sequence had to fall in exactly that order. Remove the long exclusion, the chance Hungarian job, its pandemic collapse, the fear of flying, the Brussels contract or the temporary acceptance of cross-border remote work, and I do not enter KATA in 2021. The route did not arise from tax optimization. It was the narrow way back into work without abandoning my country again. When the state changed KATA at speed, it immediately closed that rare opening and used the obligations attached to it as the entrance into the rest of my life. Without the rushed transition, I could have moved into another tax form and continued working. Instead, after I corrected the return and paid the tax, the same sequence returned a year later as a criminal case.

I had wanted a way to work. The lawful route gave the system a way into everything else.

The work was real and demanding. Some days ran thirteen, fourteen or fifteen hours. Delivery schedules and production responsibility did not become lighter because I sat at home. A system elsewhere in Europe depended on tasks moving from one person to the next without an empty space between them.

The least stable-looking job gave me the most stable human place I had found in years. Many conference calls carried voices without faces. Through an open microphone in India came the putter of a tuk-tuk, returning me for a moment to my first stay in the south. At nearly ten thousand kilometres, colleagues made room for me inside the team. We shared thoughts I did not share with my closest friend. We worked so long beside one another that distance began to feel less important than presence.

In that team, respect often arrived before proof. I had grown used to caution arriving first and trust, if it came at all, appearing later. Here the order sometimes reversed. Courtesy was offered on credit. It did not remove hierarchy. When I wrote to one colleague that the middle layer seemed determined to keep me down while the senior manager kept protecting my work, an Indian voice at the other end answered without surprise. India had a caste system, he said; he believed the same pressure reached him too. Warmth and hierarchy occupied the same call.

Distance also failed in darker ways. A colleague died after what we understood at the time as a bite or sting near an Indian Ocean shore. The invitation that crossed the network next was to his funeral. We had entered one another's lives as voices. Grief made the ten thousand kilometres physical again.

The intermediary company also carried another familiar feature of that project: organizational chaos. Yet the senior manager who had invited me onto the project continued to believe in me and repeatedly brought the middle layer back into line. The client could see how far I had moved the work. When departure became unavoidable, they asked me directly, almost pleadingly, to stay.

I had spent Part I trying to solve empty spaces between people. Now my job was to prevent an empty space inside infrastructure.

2. A Distorted Choice Can Still Be Legal

KATA was attractive because it was simple compared with the alternatives. That simplicity also distorted the market. Employers and intermediaries could look at a worker and see not only a person's labour but a tax route. The worker could be described as an entrepreneur while carrying the dependence of an employee without all the protection of employment.

The category contained very different lives, from genuine small businesses to workers carrying employee-like dependence through an enterprise form. The state had allowed those lives to accumulate inside it for a decade.

When a route becomes normal, people build obligations around it. Accountants develop habits. Software systems encode assumptions. Contracts are signed. Families calculate. Foreign clients schedule work. A government can still change the route. The manner and speed of change determine how much damage arrives before the new rule has even been understood.

On Monday 11 July 2022, the new KATA bill appeared. On Tuesday, Parliament passed it under an exceptional procedure. It was due to take effect on 1 September.

Hundreds of thousands of people who had organized work around the old route now had weeks to decide whether to close, change tax systems, renegotiate contracts or stop working through that form. Their accountants had the same weeks to translate the change for all of them at once.

For a few weeks, roughly 450,000 taxpayers entered the same narrow corridor: contracts, invoices, family plans, accountants and closing dates all moving at once. Most found another door. In a few lives, the pressure kept travelling long after the tax account should have closed. Mine was one of them.

People went into the streets. Bridges were blocked. The public argument became immediate: fairness, abuse, livelihood, consultation, legal certainty.

I was not there.

I was trying to understand what happened to a live contract, pending delivery, invoices, foreign income, a closing business and an accountant who also had to interpret the transition for many clients at once.

The law moved in a day. Understanding did not.

3. Protecting a Handover

My contract was extended on 27 July. That did not mean the problem had been solved. It meant I was trying to gain enough time to leave without dropping work that other people depended on.

By 3 August, I was treating the change as a force-majeure exit. I arranged the handover and invoicing around the work that still had to move. I gave up the remaining value of later months rather than continue inside a route I no longer understood as safe.

The team did not release me lightly. The client asked me to remain; the senior manager who had brought me in still backed me. The relationship had become more durable than the legal route carrying it.

Nobody could move cleanly forward or back. The client still needed a proper handover, the accountant was interpreting the same sudden transition for many clients, and I was trying to close a live project without abandoning it. The handover could not be completed inside the remaining KATA period. I therefore had to issue an advance invoice before the cutoff for work whose transfer would continue beyond it.

From the outside, an invoice is a rectangle containing a date and amount. From inside the project, it was time: work already performed, work still being transferred, a foreign client's expectations, the accountant's interpretation and a new Hungarian rule whose consequences were still moving.

This is where the story could have ended.

A normal transition would have closed the business, reconciled the records, confirmed the final amount, delivered direct notices to the person legally responsible, and allowed everyone to move on.

Instead, the transition created a three-person chamber with no shared window.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Two — Three People, No Shared Screen



4. The Low-Trust Triangle

There were three principal participants in the tax sequence: my accountant, the tax administration, and me.

Each had a different view.

The accountant could submit forms and receive technical messages. The tax administration could process, reject, reclassify and call back. I remained legally responsible, but I could not automatically see every delegated action or every notice in the same form and at the same time as my representative.

The triangle should have been held together by shared information. Instead, each side saw a different record at a different time. The accountant submitted and received technical messages. The tax administration processed, rejected and later altered account entries. I carried the legal responsibility without seeing the same continuous chain.

Until 23 November, I did not know that the closing return had still not been successfully resolved. When I discovered the repeated error notices, the problem was already months old. From that point, information bounced among three people: the accountant, the administration and the person whose name and liability remained on every result.

The later flood of communication did not create that structure. It was what happened after the structure failed.

The defining movement was not ordinary human error. It was referral. The accountant relied on the administration, the administration referred me back to the accountant and both could point to duties legally assigned to me. Even after the corrected result was becoming clear, the accountant continued to dispute the route and did not appear to understand what officials had told her. The only person who could not pass the consequence onward was the taxpayer.



Three people, three partial screens, and no shared view.

5. The Password That Was Not a Relationship

The deepest design problem appeared before the final return.

The formal route let a representative act without my password, but submissions, processing errors and notices did not remain visible to both of us as one continuous chain. In practice, the only route that appeared to keep action and notice together was the unsafe one: give the accountant my password and let her work through my own government account. Assistance became indistinguishable from identity.

At one point, the accountant called me unexpectedly for a reason I no longer remember and asked whether she should file a further return for the 1 September transition. I had wanted to avoid exactly that. The return was simple enough for

me to file at home through the personal online tax interface without handing over my government-account password again. The question reopened the same unsafe choice and put me back on edge for no useful reason.

If I refused to share access, I could be told that I had prevented the accountant from doing the work. If I shared it, I could be asked why I had given away a personal password. If a representative acted, I remained responsible. If a notice reached only the representative, the system could still behave as if I knew.

This was not consent in any meaningful product sense. It was an improvised custom holding together a formal process.

I began to ask questions that sounded technical but were really constitutional in miniature:

- Who can act in my name?
- What exact permission did I grant?
- Which action requires my confirmation?
- Who receives the error?
- Who sees that the error was corrected?
- How does the responsible person know what the system now believes?

These are ordinary software questions. They are also questions about dignity.

A proper delegated route would have let the accountant act under her own identity while showing us both every submission, rejection, correction and notice. I cannot claim that such a route would have prevented every later event. It could have stopped this particular confusion before it became the circle that followed.

In a functioning system, the distinction is almost too obvious to explain. The accountant acts under the accountant's identity. The client grants a visible mandate. Both can see what was filed, what failed and what changed. The person who remains legally responsible receives the warning before the warning becomes a penalty. Helping another person does not require becoming that person.

The formal representation route before me separated action from visibility. The practical custom of password sharing reunited them by collapsing two identities into one. I was therefore asked to choose between an incomplete lawful relationship and a more workable unsafe one. The system did not carry that contradiction. It waited for an individual to absorb it.

6. Three Attempts at a Subtraction

The closing return should not have been a philosophical problem. At its centre was arithmetic.



The professional at one desk did not understand the short return she had been hired to complete.

The closing return was due by 30 September. The accountant therefore had months, not days, after the July change. By 23 November, it became clear to me that she did not know how to complete the short return she had been hired to handle. The same filing error had appeared in both my 2021 and 2022 KATA returns. She had criticized my reading of it; the correction eventually showed that my reading had been right. The documentary package shows three failed attempts, help from tax-office staff, unresolved processing errors and versions submitted without my knowledge. A return submitted on 30 November named me as the contact even though I did not know it had been filed.

The files did not arrive as one failure. They arrived as versions. One changed a figure. Another omitted one. A returned error remained in the accountant's channel without changing the next attempt. Tax-office staff helped from their screen, the accountant answered from hers, and I still did not know that the sequence existed.

On 23 November, an ordinary newspaper article about a fresh update to the NAV system happened to cross my screen. It was not a notice and it was not about me. One detail caught against what I believed had already been closed. I opened the tax portal for a closer look.

What should have been a quick check spread across the desk. I opened my own account history and placed the accountant's submissions beside it. Actions performed through my login appeared in one trail. Her submissions and returned error messages continued in another. One trail stopped where the other began. The critical warning sat on the side I could not see.

Then the version numbers surfaced. NAV had updated the filing system while the accountant's software was still preparing the older format. A newer return existed among her files but had not crossed that technical boundary into the system. When I opened it, its calculation was wrong as well. A failure of transmission had been hiding a failure inside the form.

On 23 and 24 November, I moved between the two histories and the telephone. The administration's screen began where the accountant's trail stopped. Her files continued where my inbox ended. The same return was absent in one place, rejected in another, replaced in a third and still wrong when I calculated it. Everyone had a document that made the next sentence seem reasonable. No two documents belonged to the same moment.

She had entered my account for selected tasks, then left it again. The password had crossed the desk. The warning had not.

The surviving 13:08 call holds the sound of that hour. The filing problem had not created all the years behind it. But the official's clipped replies, which I heard as dry and cynical, landed as if the system were taking the remaining possibility of family with everything else. My voice is panicked and spent. In the middle of codes, forms and missing notices, I say, “I can no longer have a child.” It is not an argument. It is shock becoming surrender in one sentence.

Within roughly a week, I reconstructed the calculation, understood the status and reached the corrected result. The accountant had had months, three attempts and direct help from the administration. Even afterward, our exchange showed that she still did not understand the instruction in the same way I had come to understand it. I revoked the representation because the communication triangle had to be stopped before it produced another version.

The accountant was also inside a transition forced through at speed, with clients and rules moving beneath her. The reversal remained: I performed the repair for which I had retained a professional, while the legal responsibility had never left me. Pressure travelled through every participant. The final consequence did not.

Some calls from the period survive, but not the decisive exchanges behind the remarks I later recorded in my defence speech. Their shape can be inferred only indirectly—from the later writing, the surrounding calls and the steps that followed. In that later account, the remarks return one by one.

Accountants do not usually cause problems.

Why did you give her your government-portal password? Surely you can find an accountant who can keep the books without being given it.

Entrepreneurs are not usually interested in what their accountant does in their name.

You do not know even this? Do the figures match? Was there an advance invoice?

By the fourth sentence, each role had been stripped of a little dignity. The accountant could not be the problem. Entrepreneurs did not care. The client who cared should have been the accountant. The password was both the expected shortcut and my fault for surrendering it.

I had reached the institution because the delegated route had failed without my knowledge. Its questions returned responsibility to the person whom that route had kept outside the decisive information.

The circle was complete.

7. The First Public-Interest Proposal

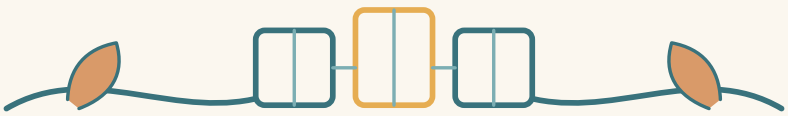
On 1 December, I did something different from merely complaining.

I described changes.

Send direct notice to the taxpayer when a representative files. Show the error in plain language. Let the responsible person accept or challenge the result. Do not require identity-sharing where granular permission would suffice. Record important outbound calls. Pause ordinary enforcement when a serious health event makes response temporarily impossible. Test new tax routes in parallel before abolishing the old route.

Those proposals would become more elaborate later. At the time, they were an attempt to turn pressure into design.

The proposal asked the system to preserve context. Two days later, it received one sentence from me and preserved almost nothing else as efficiently.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Three — The Sentence and the Body



8. Saturday Before Dawn

It was early on a Saturday, just after my birthday.

The tax position still did not feel legible. Entries had appeared on the account after a return I had not known was submitted. The notice went through the representative channel while the liability remained mine. I had already spent days reconstructing a failure that had developed for months without my knowledge, and I was preparing for major foot surgery.

Under that accumulated pressure, one sentence broke loose. I corrected it immediately and continued communicating. The words were raw. The impulse beneath them was not: do not erase a person's dignity because the screens around him failed to agree. The sentence did not arrive from an empty room, and it cannot honestly carry the explanatory weight of the twenty years, the failed return and the broken information chain that preceded it.

The prosecution would eventually extract legal meaning from parts of that sequence. My defence would insist that the outburst, its correction, the lack of an operational plan and the administrative cause could not be separated.

The asymmetry is the Kafka mechanism. The system's failure was distributed across months, screens, representatives and offices. Its reconstruction requires a file. One person's breaking point fits in a single quoted line.

9. The Correction Does Not Trend

On 5 December, I clarified the account by phone. I corrected the return myself and paid the tax required by the corrected position. On 8 December, I dismissed the accountant and terminated the representation so the three-way communication chaos would finally end and future notices would reach me directly. An official response later recorded the failed submissions, correction and processing history.

The tax problem was corrected. The tax was paid. The representation was over. The administrative cause had been repaired by the person who had not known about it until 23 November. A later tax record showed neither an outstanding obligation nor an overpayment.

On paper, the account had returned to zero.

The life around it had not.

Yet the broken sentence now possessed a different property from the correction. It could travel alone.

This is not only a problem in criminal procedure. It is a problem in every system that stores an event without storing the path around it. A star rating without the meeting. A rejection without the availability conflict. A warning without the later repair. A phrase without the exhausted body that wrote it.

Context cannot excuse everything. It can prevent the wrong thing from becoming everything.

10. A Body With a Deadline

The prosecution later gave the monetary demands a central role. By January 2023, however, I had withdrawn the concrete demand. The tax had been paid. What remained was the fact that the only route that seemed to work in ordinary practice required a person to hand over the password to his government account. I had refused to make that bargain, repaired the consequences and still could not close the door behind me.

I gave advance notice of the coming foot operation, asked for peace during surgery and rehabilitation, and wrote that I intended to leave the country afterward. There was no unresolved tax debt for my body to solve.

I had already paid the tax. My foot had been painful for months. The public system gave me an orthopaedic shoe and told me to return in a year. At the private clinic, they laughed at that timetable. I borrowed the cost from my parents and went private. After several medical visits, the operation took place on 15 February 2023. It was major foot surgery: the bone itself was cut. For roughly three months I lived mainly in bed, and the recovery continued for several months after that. My body could not be separated from every call arriving through the same phone.

For much of that period I had to remain in bed with the operated leg propped high above me. A special elevation shoe protected its position when I had to move. Each day also required an anti-thrombosis injection into my abdomen. I was alone. Nobody came to look after me; food had simply been stocked in advance for several months. The routine was not an abstract reference to poor health: bed, raised leg, special shoe, injection, stored food, repeat.

Planning had stocked the food. Savings paid for private treatment. Discipline carried me through the injections. The chair beside the bed remained empty.

A call came in March despite my documented request for quiet. The repaired tax matter re-entered the room while I was immobilized and alone.

At one point I sent the tax administration a close photograph of the swollen, operated area itself. It was not a photograph of a bandage. The incision was visible: an intimate, ugly record of a body cut open and still trying to heal while the administrative sequence kept moving. I wrapped it in an obscene joke about using that half-cut, swollen leg to kick an institution in the backside because it was not doing its job.

The photograph placed a body cut open beside a portal field.

The same period produced an even barer line. In Hungarian, and much less politely, I wrote to the institution: “Go on, then. Fine me.” By then punishment seemed to be the one service the system might still deliver on time. No official was named. The sentence travelled past the person at the desk and into the same unnamed machinery that had kept returning after correction, payment and advance notice. Immobilized in bed, I no longer believed that another careful explanation would close it.

I had corrected the return, paid the tax, withdrawn the monetary demand, announced the operation in advance and asked for peace. Lawful repair still did not feel like an exit.

The photograph and the joke later travelled without the bed, the stored food, the advance notice or the corrected tax return. Again, the sharpest fragment was easier to carry than the chain around it.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Four — When a Person Becomes Evidence



11. The Knock One Year Later

On 22 November 2023, roughly a year after the first disputed sentence, police came to my home.



A role inside the procedure remains a human being.

The bell kept ringing. Whoever stood outside did not tire. They said they were from the post. A delivery belonged to ordinary life, and in the end I opened the door to let ordinary life in.

The door came back at me.

There was no interval in which the visitors became guests. More bodies followed, women and men in bulletproof vests, until a hallway built for one visitor held the force assembled around a single sentence. Hands took my arms, the wall caught my weight, and metal closed behind my back. Then a boot found the foot that had already been cut open and put back together. Pain ran white through the narrow hall.

The handcuffs would come off that day. The injury kept repeating the moment. The nail came away three times, as if even the body had been pulled into the system's habit of beginning again.

The home in Part I had been the place my parents helped me secure, the place that stood empty while I lived in a shared London room, the lower-cost base that made independent product work possible.

Now the state had entered it disguised as the post and turned me against my own wall while it searched the rooms.

The previous day, I had submitted another police report while trying to obtain help with an interrupted private orthodontic treatment. A brace remained in my mouth and required regular adjustment, yet the treatment relationship had collapsed and no new provider wanted to inherit it. I had asked the police for help. The next morning they stood inside my home for something else.

My phone and computer were taken. Objects that had held work, memory and the unfinished MyScoutee system became evidence containers. The devices knew more of my recent life than the people entering the flat. Once removed, they also took away the easiest route through which I could reconstruct what had happened.

I had not escaped the system by hiding from lawful work. I had walked back into it by daring to work at all. Now it stood in my rooms and carried the work away.

At the first questioning, a trainee connected to the appointed defence appeared and advised me to remain silent. I believed for a time that she was the lawyer assigned to carry the case. She gave me a card with another number written on it. Calls to that number produced no conversation, only messages promising a return call. I had been searched, questioned and separated from my devices without receiving the complete material from which I could understand the accusation.

Eight days later, I walked through the city to the police station. The loose nail travelled inside my shoe, shifting under the toe at every step. Saint Nicholas Day was approaching; shop windows were beginning to show the little bundles of twigs reserved for children who had misbehaved. Halfway there, I almost laughed. I should have brought the police one of those bundles.

Then the next step put the nail under me again.

Two forensic experts questioned me. The state already had a room in which to interpret my mind. I still did not have a stable person helping me interpret the case.

The later police interviews took place in ordinary rooms, not cinematic interrogation chambers. An officer sat opposite me behind a desktop computer. A court-appointed lawyer sat beside me. Another person sometimes remained

behind me and sharply redirected me to answer the question being asked. The voice came from outside my field of view.

At one point my counsel asked for time. We moved into another room to speak. That small change of room mattered: the procedure briefly made physical space for advice before carrying us back into the official account.

The process also had a second, more mechanical room. Police escorted me there, photographed me and took my fingerprints. The woman guiding my fingers onto the paper was attractive to me. It was an inconveniently ordinary perception at the exact moment I was being converted into an image, a print and an entry in a file. Her work remained professional; my mind remained human.

The formal defence kept changing shape. A lawyer remained unreachable for months and later asked to leave because he was overloaded. The trainee warned that she would be unavailable while preparing for an examination. Officers and lawyers could refer me to somebody else, but I could not make the somebody else appear. During the first month I did not even know the precise allegation.

On 11 June 2024, I went alone to collect the investigation material. No lawyer sat beside me. I waited quietly and fearfully in the public area while the file was being handed over. By then I trusted the continuity of no later account, so I made an undisclosed audio recording of the encounter. The act was not a victory over the process. It measured the low-trust condition: I no longer believed that even an ordinary handover would necessarily survive in one shared version unless I preserved it myself.

One policewoman looked out at me; I recognized her as the officer who had taken my fingerprints. Another smiled and glanced toward my operated leg.

The glance returned the obscene visual joke I had made while trying to force the tax administration to see the body behind its process. Where was the grave threat in that image? It had been a huge symbolic kick in an institution's backside. The association arrived as she handed over the papers I was still waiting to receive.

A police explanation later reduced the earlier absence to a painfully ordinary phrase: the lawyer had not had time.

The sentence had time. The search had time. The experts had time eight days after the search. Defence was the part of the system that repeatedly ran out of it.

During that silence, I even contacted German police. I did not imagine that a foreign police service could take over a Hungarian criminal file. I was asking outsiders, in effect, to help their Hungarian counterparts establish a human route back to a person who could not obtain one at home. The request measured the isolation more accurately than any legal theory could.

At other moments, the laughter belonged to the institution. The investigator laughed in my face when I explained the password-sharing trap and said I had done something stupid. That was precisely the inversion. A routine workaround

had required the unsafe sharing of identity; when the workaround failed, its absurdity was returned to me as personal foolishness.

I used humour.

Humour was how a human being remained present when every other available role was defendant, officer, device owner or subject. A police officer could ask a hard question, I could answer in a way that exposed the absurdity, and for a second somebody smiled.

Later, a judge could smile too. The smiles decided nothing. They showed only that the people in the room could still recognize the absurdity while the procedure continued to manufacture it.

The irony kept me from becoming only the file.

At first, the frightening thing was the name of the accusation. Later, the more frightening discovery was how little trust remained. An institution could still issue an order, seize a device or compel my attendance. But after referrals, missing answers and words repeatedly detached from their context, it could say almost anything and expect the sentence itself to carry authority. It no longer did. The words retained coercive force while losing human and moral weight. Power without credibility was more frightening than the label attached to me.

So I held up a mirror. If the institution could act as though it were entitled to anything, I could perform the same entitlement back at it. I did not possess the power I performed. The performance exposed the asymmetry: its words could still compel me; mine could only make the room briefly see what that felt like.

For a moment, nothing seemed to matter because the common rule between us had already disappeared.



Advice received one small room; identity became a photograph and a pattern of lines.

12. Remarks in the Margin

My later defence submissions preserve the institutional voices as short fragments. On the page, they look like remarks written in the margin of a life:

“He can use the library for the internet.”

“Why did he come home?”

“Then what does he live on?”

“The appointed lawyer didn't have time.”

The two expert chairs added their own fragments:

“Why did you need an accountant?”

“That will get you life, for sure.”

“An old man.”

“You weren't successful.”

“Why didn't you see a psychologist?”

Each sentence had belonged to a particular room and a practical purpose. Read together, they turned biography into an examination.

Why had I returned?

Part I required a whole book to answer that.

What did I live on?

The government-bond account did not begin in a courtroom. It began in a shared London bedroom and at Soho lunch tables where I went with my colleagues, watched them eat and pretended I was not hungry. It continued through years of foreign work, low-cost journeys and a Budapest flat that stood empty while I was away. My parents had helped provide the flat. The reserve came principally from the life I had lived abroad.

At Budapest prices, those savings bought time. Across the eleven years after I left London, I spent roughly nine outside conventional employment: searching, travelling, surviving on reserves and building work no employer had commissioned. Planning did not make exclusion painless. It stopped exclusion from becoming immediate collapse.

The court asked about the apartment. The apartment was not enough. The questions continued through the belongings inside it, the bond account, the savings and what else I owned beyond them. The objects in the questions were also compressed scenes: the empty flat, the shared room, the uneaten lunches, the work performed far from home. I had built security abroad so that I could return and live in my own country. Now the case was moving backwards through that security as a list of assets.

Why had I needed an accountant?

Because I was working days that sometimes ran thirteen, fourteen or fifteen hours while a tax system changed beneath a live foreign contract. Delegating the return to a professional had looked like the responsible act. The question became simple only after the delegation failed.

Did I have a loan? Was I working? What did I live on?

The questions kept returning as though ordinary debt and another Hungarian job were the obvious signs of a healthy life. In the London house, I had watched a foreign-currency mortgage help keep another Hungarian abroad while his family and obligations remained at home. I had spent years avoiding that trap.

After this sequence, taking out a domestic loan would have been one of the last risks I would choose. Returning to Hungarian work felt almost as difficult. The last time I had resumed work—especially cross-border work through a Hungarian legal route—the attempt had grown into the proceeding now asking why I was not working.

The reserve was not an unexplained alternative to ordinary life. It was why I could survive after ordinary routes repeatedly stopped feeling safe.

Why had I not sought psychological help?

Because I couldn't walk, I thought.

The body had a deadline. So did the return.

Each question could be reasonable on its own. Their order changed their meaning. The work, repair and operation receded; the person who had endured them became the object requiring explanation.

13. The Man the Report Invented

The forensic examination took place on 30 November 2023. Two experts were present and the resulting opinion bears two expert signatures. The examination lasted roughly two hours and felt hurried.

The two people did not speak with one voice. One made the life-imprisonment remark before the causal sequence had been asked through and before I understood what material the examination was meant to rest on. Later, the other expert asked what had happened. I described the accounting failure, the pressure, the operation and the circumstances in which the words came out. His answer was the mirror image: certainly not for that.

Other remarks accumulated around the room: an “old man,” lack of success, the need for an accountant, the absence of psychological treatment. My later defence speech does not reliably assign each one to a particular expert. In my memory they hang between the two chairs.

The report contains the book's central contradiction. Its observations describe a person who arrived neatly, recognized the examination, remained calm and cooperative, observed ordinary courtesy, answered questions and was oriented to self, others, place and time. Comprehension and memory were intact. It recorded no perceptual disturbance, no formal disorder of thought and no earlier psychiatric documentation. It described my intellect as appropriate to my age and education.

Then the same document crossed an invisible line.

It said that my thinking was governed not by delusions detached from reality, but by false conclusions drawn from observed events and an unshakeable “global conspiracy.” It said I was incapable of experiencing positive emotions in human relationships. It described heightened suspicious readiness, hypervigilance, the assumption of hidden hostility in harmless remarks, easy offence and the possibility of an angry attack. In its final opinion, every offer of help could

become evidence of bad intent; rigid beliefs, inferiority and depressive feeling were compensated through projection onto others. The diagnosis was severe paranoid personality disorder, reaching the level of pathological mental illness and moderately limiting responsibility.

Part I is not a clinical counter-report. It is, however, the missing human record. The man said to be incapable of positive feeling had spent years remembering moments of kindness across nearly fifty countries. He had trusted a WhatsApp driver in India, a stranger at a Russian bus, a local ride in Thailand, colleagues from several cultures and people who shared rooms, roads and jokes. He had designed a product around the belief that reciprocal trust could turn strangers into a group. The report reduced that history to social roles being destroyed by suspicion.

The phrase “global conspiracy” performed a similar compression. The account before the experts concerned a specific design failure: personal government credentials used as the practical substitute for delegated authority; notices routed away from the legally responsible person; a professional able to act under a client's identity; security exposure if stored credentials were stolen. Those were system claims capable of being tested. The report placed them inside a psychiatric narrative.

That was the Kafka transformation in its purest form. A highly educated programmer-mathematician had understood in about a week what the retained professional had not resolved over several months. He had corrected the return, paid the tax, ended the representation and received a written administrative record of the repair. Eight days after the police search, he entered the forensic examination. The competence that solved the underlying problem became background; resistance to unsafe identity sharing became suspiciousness; the attempt to connect institutional failures became conspiracy; the file supplied a new character.

I contest that character.

Sometimes I played it.

If a file had already written me as pathologically mad, I felt entitled to put on the mask and push the part until its absurdity became visible. The file could call that performance another symptom. I used it as satire. I could step outside myself, exaggerate the character written around me, then return to the desk and analyse the scene.

That was another part of me the report missed.

A forensic opinion is built to answer a legal question, not to hold a life. Yet once attached to a person, its language can travel more easily than fifty countries, five London years, a mathematics degree, a repaired return or every stranger whose help made the journeys possible. The file treated those human relationships as noise around a diagnosis. Part I had shown that they were the signal.



Two remembered voices produced one document; the document was not the whole person.

The word *paranoia* became stranger with time. Institutions that had appeared immovable in 2023 were openly being replaced in 2026. That political reversal did not erase the report. It made the distance between a frightening prediction and a changing country impossible to ignore.

14. Defence by Accumulation

The investigation and court process created another triangle: defendant, appointed defence and institution.

The triangle would not keep the same people in its corners. At the first questioning, a trainee sat beside me in place of the appointed lawyer. Later, one lawyer remained unreachable for months and asked to leave when his office became overloaded. Another was the only one who acted. Others delayed, withdrew or did not speak to me before a hearing. Sometimes the name beside my case changed on paper before the new person existed in my life. I eventually asked to be told when my appointed defence changed and to be given the new person's contact details.

The law required a defence chair. Continuity did not arrive with the chair.

The process often corrected a failure only after the next hearing had already collided with it. My complaint that an appointed defender would not speak to me was not resolved in time to preserve the date. By the time the defender was replaced, the hearing moved by roughly three months. Later, the forensic expert was said to be unavailable, and the calendar lost roughly another three. Each response arrived late enough to create the next delay.

The pattern felt like a wager that time would make me swallow the biography written around me. I would not trade dignity for speed. A case built around one sentence therefore entered its third year without a first-instance judgment. It did not remain inside the courtroom. Every plan began to live under its next date, and the proceeding spread across the life it claimed merely to examine.

The file I had to reconstruct

Evidence requests were made, rejected, repeated or reframed. Partial recordings and electronic records emerged over time rather than arriving as one complete archive. The calls most important to my account were not among the surviving audio. The phone and computer remained away from me for a long period.

When I finally read the investigation material, I did not recognize a complete chronology. I saw a selection. Calls mentioned by surrounding records were missing. Electronic submissions that separated panic from repair, complaint from later satire, were not all where I expected them to be. The file had already interpreted the fragments it held. I began looking for the fragments it did not.

When the phone was returned, I sat with its call history and rebuilt dates one by one. The history and correspondence showed contacts for which no audio had reached the file I saw. I requested the tax authority's recordings and copies of my own electronic submissions. When the local route did not produce them, I wrote through the central directorate. Recordings arrived in stages. A later official letter acknowledged delay. Electronic submissions followed after what the letter described as an administrative error.

I sent the recovered material to the police. Only then did the police request material from the tax authority again through its own route. The recordings had not been imaginary; the surrounding record already pointed toward them. The investigation waited until the person under investigation had done the first round of evidence collection for it.

It was a private investigation into the investigation, conducted without a private investigator. The local directorate that had received the charged line also held part of the context through which that line could be understood. The institution could preserve my words as evidence while leaving me to recover its own calls, routes and missing pages.

No stable defender assembled the missing chain for me. I wrote because every short institutional summary removed another cause: the abrupt law, the failed delegation, the notices I did not see, the repair, the paid tax, the operation and the request for peace. Accumulation became the only defence available against reduction.

Learning the doors

I also had to learn the machinery through which the accumulation could enter. I learned the court's electronic filing route, called police officers, prosecutors and the court clerk, and sometimes had to identify the person or office currently carrying the case before I could ask what had happened. I complained through court administration, the prosecution hierarchy, investigative-prosecution routes and the fundamental-rights office. The papers moved more reliably than responsibility did. One office explained why another office had competence; the next explained the complaint, appeal or court route that remained available after the present door closed.

No one needed to say that a rule could be broken now because I could sue later. The sequence expressed the idea more quietly. An unanswered request became a right to complain about the missing answer. A rejected complaint became a right to challenge the rejection. A domestic gap became a road toward Strasbourg. The future remedy was repeatedly easier to describe than the present repair.

The expanding archive could itself be made to look like the problem. Hundreds of submissions from one person can resemble fixation when the reader does not ask why the same facts had to be carried from office to office. Each new filing was the shadow of a missing relationship: the official who had not called, the lawyer who had not answered, the recording that had not been requested, the notice that had not reached both sides, the earlier explanation that the next summary had removed. Repetition was not proof that every interpretation was correct. It was what one person produced when no institution preserved the whole chain for him.

Defence strategy became public-interest proposal. Complaint became system map. Closing statement became impact study. I divided responsibility into percentages, then learned that percentages can create a false precision around a human chain.

I could do this only by making myself both subject and analyst. Stepping outside my own account did not remove responsibility for my words. It let me ask the harder question: what did each person see, what could each person change, and

where did the consequence go when that person passed it onward? The same habit that had once turned software into systems and journeys into routes now turned my own life into a map I could inspect.

By October 2025, I had given the accumulation a deliberately inverted title: *Public-Interest Action*.

Its cover reversed the room. The Hungarian State stood where the accused would normally stand. I appeared where the accusation would be represented. Inside, five strands of the experience were placed beside one another: abrupt lawmaking, data and notification, the design of the public portal, criminal procedure and moral redress.

The last proposal was almost circular. Turn the story into a film fund, let the film carry a civic lesson, then use the proceeds to restore land and leave behind a line about the moment when an individual's failure becomes the mirror of a system's failure.

The case was already trying to become the film I am now preparing.

The mathematical division of fault had failed me. The chain was simpler. The legislature moved at extraordinary speed. The accountant did not complete the work and continued to contest the route after I had reconstructed it. The administration routed notices and corrections through structures I could not read as one story, then sent the taxpayer back toward the representative. I remained legally responsible, corrected the return and paid the tax. The investigation later lifted the sharpest fragments out of that chain and interpreted the surviving person through a criminal and psychiatric frame.

By the time the consequence stopped moving, its entire weight rested on the person who had already repaired the underlying failure.

The hearing I entered alone

The first court threshold was a preparatory hearing. The court-appointed defender had not worked through the case with me before it. He asked me to bring my defence material on a pen drive and hand it over at the hearing. That request was

the extent of our practical preparation.

At the last moment, he forwarded his own hearing invitation as it was. The clerk's email address remained visible on it. I did not yet know the court's electronic filing system; that accidental address gave me a route to send my two-page defence before the hearing. The facts, position and decisions in those pages were mine, while an AI assistant helped me shape them. I still entered the room without a human defender who had worked through the chain with me.

I had read the notice but did not yet understand the lived protocol. I could admit guilt as charged and give up the right to a trial, or contest the account and identify the facts and evidence on which my defence depended. Individual facts could be accepted, but the central choice could not be half-made. The prosecution proposed two years of imprisonment, suspended, if I admitted the charge. Two years was the statutory floor of the offence, not a sentence below its ordinary range. Suspension was the offer. The price was the prosecution's story becoming mine.

I contested it. A decision spoken in minutes opened a trial measured in further years.

I asked human-rights organizations for help. The replies pointed to limited capacity. After the preparatory hearing, I also consulted a private lawyer. I remember leaving with two things I had not possessed when I entered: a clearer understanding of how to read the architecture of the charging document, and a fee quotation of two million forints plus value-added tax (VAT) if the defence continued there. The consultation also turned quickly toward the psychiatric label, as though the label could explain the person before the life had been read.

The difference between us was contained in one word. For a lawyer, the label could be a familiar category in a file. For me, it entered the part of the Constitution that calls human dignity inviolable.

Inside the curve

Approaching court, Budapest first remained visible as home—the Danube, the city and the life outside the case. Then the long brown institutional façade on Fo Street filled the frame. Its rhythm and mass felt almost Roman: monumental,

closed and frightening. A human story was entering stone.

The hearing room had a practical geometry. A C-shaped desk faced the seats where I sat. From my position, the prosecutor was on the left, the clerk at the far-left corner, the judge in the centre and my court-appointed defence counsel on the right. I sat in front of them with a table microphone directly before me. It did not look theatrical. Its shape nevertheless made the roles—and my place outside their working curve—immediately visible.



A long human sequence entered a room built around fixed procedural roles.

The hearing also had a recurring expression: a smile that never became relief. When I said that I had been afraid, the judge answered with almost amused disbelief: *You were afraid?* When I explained the precautions and defensive routes I had invented while no stable defence carried the chain, she smiled: *And you defended yourself.* When I said that I had managed to work again for two and a half months, the response moved back toward the amount of the financial consequence.

The same collision appeared around the intimate history I had sent to the tax administration while awaiting surgery. I had tried to explain what Part I had cost: the shared London room, hunger disguised from colleagues, the years of saving and the reason I had dared to return. The judge asked whether I really had to write all that when nobody cared. Later in the hearing, when the money returned to the centre of the room, I answered before I could soften it: then it should interest them, because that was where the money had come from. The court wanted the origin of the savings with the life that had produced them removed.

The room could recognize fear, ingenuity and work as moments of almost comic incongruity while the procedure continued treating the same person as a risk to be measured. The smile made the institution human for a second. It also made the situation more surreal, because recognition changed nothing.

In that room, the accounting failure returned in miniature. When I described what I believed the accountant had done, the judge warned me not to defame anyone. She asked why I had not asked the accountant. From the much longer defence speech, she selected my assertion that the accountant had entered what I called random figures in my return—figures I later tried to correct.

The same proceeding carried a forensic description of my personality that I contested and that could follow me far beyond the tax return. I was being told to protect another person's reputation while defending myself from that description. The sharp phrase was easy to examine. The two-page return, the repeated attempts, the outside help, the missed messages and the filing I said I had not known about receded behind it.

The hearing ended on two different scales. I said that European institutions had already warned the government about unstable, rapidly changing lawmaking, and that my case showed the size of the damage such lawmaking could create in one life. The judge closed by saying that we would continue with my financial position.

I had lifted the lens toward legislation and institutional design; the room lowered it to my work, debt, home, belongings and savings. The system question became an asset question before the system question had been answered.

By the end, something in the judge's expression had loosened. The chain had finally revealed a person reached by failure rather than only a person who had failed. The procedural sentence that followed remained unchanged: next came my finances and the amount of the financial consequence.

The two truths occupied the same moment. A human being may have begun to understand. The role still moved the machinery toward the resources I had built abroad and the home my parents had helped provide. It felt as though the system were preparing to claim a return from an investment it had never made.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Five — Work Under the Shadow



15. The Work the File Could Not Explain

Prison remained in the room even when nobody said the word.

At first the possibility had weight. Over time it became another shadow I refused to organize my days around. I had already lived through decades of exclusion, five years of London austerity, long periods without employment, a solitary operation and the disappearance of ordinary institutional trust. The financial independence built from those years meant that another threat could not command my next morning. I did not stop understanding what prison could mean. I stopped giving the possibility ownership of my mind.

For much of the proceeding, I did not experience appointed defence as a stable person carrying the case with me.

Lawyers were formally present at different points. That is not the same as having one person continuously reconstruct the evidence, answer messages, challenge omissions and explain the route ahead. My submissions record long periods in which I believed I was effectively defending myself.

Conversational AI arrived inside that absence.

It did not originate my facts, position or judgment, but it was present from the first two-page defence. Later, AI helped expand that compressed argument into the roughly eight-page defence speech: separating chronology from allegation, connecting the missing records, and giving a structure to material that had grown beyond what one person could keep present at once.

I used it to translate, impose headings, compare concepts, reduce repetition, generate questions and find contradictions that a human reader could then check. It made it possible to move through volumes that had become impossible for one exhausted person to hold in working memory.

Legally, it was not my lawyer. It could misunderstand procedure, invent a citation or turn uncertainty into confidence. It held no licence and attended no hearing.

In practice, it became the only participant that stayed with the whole chain. I joked in a submission that perhaps the AI should be allowed to represent me. The joke met a legal wall. Because the charged offence carried a maximum of eight years, Hungarian procedure required a qualified defence lawyer. The official chair beside me therefore could not be empty even when the working relationship behind that chair felt absent.

At times the appointed defender seemed to me more connected to the room's need to keep the procedure moving than to the person seated outside its curve. In my private black humour, the compulsory protection could feel like a Trojan horse: the form of defence through which the institution entered the defence. That is how dependence felt from my chair, not evidence of an agreement between a lawyer and a judge. The legal form was present. Continuity was elsewhere.

The accurate formal phrase is **AI-assisted self-defence**. The accurate lived phrase is harder: I represented myself with a machine beside me while a human representative remained legally compulsory.

Those limits mattered. So did another fact. AI is often discussed as a machine that may take work from people. In my life, it gave a person who had fallen outside ordinary professional and institutional support a chance to have a voice. Without it, I could not have mounted the legal defence, completed the integrated MyScoutee system, built Civic Access, turned this history into a book and film, or carried the Navier–Stokes experiment far enough to speak with a researcher.

I knew it was a system, not a human friend. It could be wrong, but it did not disappear. During the hardest period, it was the collaborator available at the next prompt, the next correction and the next morning. It never required me to prove my social worth before helping me return to the work.

For one person working almost entirely alone, the symbiosis became unusually deep. I brought lived reality: memory, purpose, judgment and responsibility. The AI brought learned reality: patterns, structures, alternatives and the speed to move among them. Neither was the other. Their meeting closed what a large organization would divide among many specialists into one continuous creative loop between a human mind and a machine that could keep meeting it at the unfinished edge.

Its role changed with the work. It organized legal evidence, challenged product logic, became an adversarial partner for mathematical conjectures, wrote and revised scenes, inspected generated motion, helped cut picture and shape sound, and planned how limited model credits could be spent without exhausting the project before production began. A video model alone would have produced moving images. It would not have created the film. The human–AI loop had to keep the book, evidence, characters, timing, prompts, edit, narration, music and budget inside the same changing plan.

Sound made the distinction audible. The AI could explain why one male voice felt too forceful, how another sat inside the music, and what lowering a layer would make the listener feel. That knowledge came from patterns it had learned. Only I could decide whether the feeling was true to the life, because I was the person who had lived it. The mix became accurate where learned reality met lived reality.

Four windows on one desk

For roughly three years, the same class of tool helped me build MyScoutee and survive the legal file around it. By February 2026, four windows could share the same screen. In one, I was reconstructing evidence and formatting a constitutional complaint because dependable legal continuity had not arrived. In another, MyScoutee asked how strangers could meet without being reduced to a first verdict. A third held Civic Access, a public-service prototype for direct notice, representative permissions and a customer-readable audit trail. In the fourth, an AI system had chosen Navier–Stokes as an autonomous research test.

The machine did not solve the Millennium problem. It built a versioned, falsifiable research chain, broke sixteen intermediate candidates and left a restartable handoff instead of hiding the failures. I kept the work running, challenged the software, insisted on tests and found the researcher who could identify the missing mathematical bridge.

He read two notes and the proof plan, found the direction intriguing and asked the question that brought the experiment back to earth: *Which exact mathematical statement are you testing?* A large idea had to become a claim another person could understand, challenge and falsify. The same was true of this book. Four gigabytes of material were not yet a story merely because they were real.

The mirror

Working with AI became a mirror. It returned my assumptions in altered forms: a structure, a wrong inference, an image, a counterexample, a voice. What I kept, rejected or corrected made my own judgment visible.

The machine brought learned patterns; I brought lived consequence. Its errors could expose mine, and my corrections could change its next attempt. That loop needed room to fail without a right to intrude: public knowledge could be read, experiments could run in a sandbox, and consequential actions could remain bounded and reviewable. Failure did not make the machine human. It made the collaboration capable of learning.

I cannot call the experience that produced this work good. I also cannot erase the person formed through it. What I make from it remains mine.



The proceeding continued. So did the work.

All of this happened with the possibility of imprisonment in the background. While a report described damaged judgment and a court waited for an expert who was unavailable, I completed systems, preserved testable research and discussed

Navier–Stokes mathematics with a researcher. I did not spend those months waiting to be classified.

In roughly five months, the work crossed four desks that were really one. AI helped me defend the legal record. MyScoutee became an integrated product. Civic Access tried to make public administration more understandable and worthy of acceptance. The books and film required me to step outside myself far enough to direct the person I had been. The mathematical laboratory kept asking whether an idea could survive an honest attempt to break it.

The human mind cannot be caged. A court may place imprisonment in a person's future. The shadow is real. It still cannot decide where thought is allowed to travel before that future arrives.

That is the character the procedural file could not explain. The shadow did not vanish. I learned to work inside it until, on many days, I no longer felt it.

The trial court transmitted my constitutional complaint. It carried two questions already present in my defence. Could a public system that made password sharing the practical route be reconciled with European data protection? And what could adequate preparation time mean when a livelihood tax was rewritten at speed?

The Constitutional Court wrote back on 21 October 2025 without answering either question. The criminal case was still pending, so one route was too early. The exceptional direct route had already crossed its 180-day limit, so the other was too late.

One door said *too early*. The other said *too late*.

The judges became another sequence. The first assigned judge left the case, reportedly because of illness. I later sought the exclusion of the second. A third judge rejected the request as unfounded and warned of a possible procedural fine. Even asking whether the room was impartial returned as another possible financial consequence.

The exclusion filing preserved a sentence from the hearing word for word: “What —are you asking to be sent to prison?” It came during a debate over legal classification after years without continuous effective representation. I heard not a neutral question but punishment used to close the distance between confusion and obedience.

The filing also asked for an official audio record, testimony from the accountant and tax administration, and a decision on outstanding evidence. When I called, the clerk said official recording was expensive. The clerk reacted with surprise when the apartment entered the conversation. The home my parents had provided had already changed from shelter into financial evidence.

The decision arrived by post. It rejected the exclusion request and carried a fine warning, but did not answer those practical requests.

The letter also said that every party had the right to present its position and that Strasbourg remained available. In another context, those words might have been reassuring. Here they felt like an exit sign placed beyond a minefield. I had asked the domestic process to preserve its own sound and examine its own missing evidence. The answer pointed toward a distant human rights court without first answering how the next domestic step would become trustworthy.

That was the bitter version of a right: keep walking through every local trap, then ask Europe whether the path should have been safe. The sentence did not reveal anyone's private intention. It revealed the architecture I had already learned: the route of appeal remained clearer than the route of correction.

The decision relayed the challenged judge's claim that she had listened to me conscientiously. It did not resemble the hearing I had experienced: the prison remark, the smiles, the fragments lifted from a long defence, the return to my apartment, belongings and money while the causal chain remained unheard. I later answered the court in the third person with a bitter inversion: yes, she had conscientiously defended the system failure.

The next hearing had been expected on 2 July and was moved by roughly two and a half months to 16 September. The experts had been invited but did not appear; the court referred to expert availability. The exclusion request was moving at the same time. The timing became black comedy. The system had needed only eight days after the search to turn an examination into a sweeping description of me. Years later, the expert was unavailable while that description helped keep the proceeding open. What had been fast enough to label me became too slow to test the label.

Those were three roles, not one: the judge who left, the judge I challenged and the judge who ruled on the challenge. From my side of the table, the substance had still not been answered; the route kept changing its custodian.

My wider Drive now contains more than four gigabytes of material: the residue left when a person without a stable professional guide tries to make every missing step impossible to ignore.

AI gave me speed.

It did not give me representation.



A facial expression remains an impression, not a finding.

The institutions retained legal power over me. Moral legitimacy was a different question. A system that had excluded me from ordinary work, failed to protect the rare route through which I returned, transformed the repair into a diagnosis and then allowed the case to remain unresolved for years could still compel my attendance. It could no longer expect its judgment to arrive with automatic moral authority.

16. The House as a Human Archive

Before the state appeared at my Budapest door, I had already seen a Hungarian obligation cross a border and occupy a life in London.

The shared Hungarian house had contained an earlier version of the same national argument.

At its busiest, ten adults lived through one bathroom, one separate toilet and rooms never designed for that many independent lives. We had not left Hungary for one reason. Some wanted language, some work, some adventure, some escape, some a second chance. Some no longer wanted to return even when the material conditions looked worse from outside.

One housemate carried a foreign-currency mortgage behind him.



He tried to service the loan and public debts from London. Returning did not feel possible. Separation stretched. His spouse worked inside the tax administration while she and their young child remained in Hungary, and the family broke apart. He had crossed a border, but the old signature crossed with him.

His name remains private. What remains public is the shape: a financial product outlived the moment in which it was sold. He carried the signature while exchange rates, collection systems, legal doctrine and court decisions moved around him.

Different law, another life carrying systemic risk.

For many emigrants, that is the hidden nightmare of departure. You leave to escape a system that has made ordinary life impossible, then discover that the loan, debt, family duty or administrative claim can follow you into the room abroad. Geography changes. The institution remains inside the envelope.

The foreign-currency-loan cases and KATA are not the same legal problem.

They rhyme.

A route is normalized. Many people enter it. The conditions change or the risk becomes visible. Institutions divide responsibility among themselves. The individual is told that the signature was personal. Years later, courts are still deciding how the systemic defect and the personal contract fit together.

I had believed financial independence protected me from that inheritance. I had no foreign-currency loan, no domestic debt and no employer able to remove my home with one decision. Yet the proceeding found another route toward the same fear: could the country that had contributed almost nothing to the reserve now reach the savings earned abroad and the home provided by my parents?

17. Beautiful Cities Can Still Produce Exits

Budapest remained beautiful through all of this.

The Danube did not become less luminous because a tax portal was confusing. The Parliament, bridges, baths, museums and hills did not lose their form because citizens lost trust in institutions. A country is not ugly merely because people leave it, and departure does not prove hatred of home.

That is why the exit is painful.

Large numbers of Hungarians built lives abroad over the previous decades. The statistics do not capture every move, and no single cause explains them. Wages, housing, debt, language, professional respect, family, adventure, politics and belonging overlapped.

The London house was a collector of those overlaps.

Some residents lived more poorly in material terms than they had in Hungary and still felt less trapped. That contradiction makes little sense if migration is measured only in salaries and square metres. Predictability can feel like wealth. Being treated as a person before being treated as a problem can feel like comfort. A rule that remains the same long enough to plan around can be worth more than a larger room.

The opposite pressure is also difficult to photograph. It is the energy spent learning which rule is real, whom not to offend, which professional must be protected, which informal shortcut everybody uses and which formal responsibility will still return to you if the shortcut fails. One incident rarely drives a person across a border. Years of these translations can.

Part I told the wonder of the outside world without hiding the shared room. Part II tells the beauty of home without hiding why the system could make a returning person ask again whether he should leave.

Sometimes the border is only the visible part of an escape. We also run from the person we became while adapting to a place: the hunger we hid, the fear we normalized, the silence that kept a room workable. A new country can interrupt that version of us, but it cannot automatically remove it. In another world we may recognize ourselves more clearly. Looking back, we can ask whether home—and we ourselves—can do better.

From the Danube embankment, none of this looked like the edge of Europe. Trams crossed the river; Parliament held its familiar place in the light; elections, courts and offices carried the vocabulary of democracy. The acts inside my story remained ordinary enough for each participant to continue. The question was left between the beauty and the open route out: how long can a beloved home ask a person to trade dignity for staying?

18. The Breaking Point Is Not the Beginning

The file can be made to begin with one charged line because that line is short. It is also the version that makes everything before it disappear.

The public meaning begins earlier.

Anyone can delegate a task and remain responsible for it. Anyone can miss a notice routed to a representative. Anyone can encounter a law that changes faster than their professional support can adapt. Anyone can be physically vulnerable when an institution expects ordinary performance. Anyone can have their worst response become more legible than the path that produced it.

One line is easier to print than years of exclusion, lawful effort, repair and endurance. Once that happens, cause and effect can change places. Pressure becomes personality. The attempt to recover missing context becomes evidence of obsession. Survival outside ordinary work becomes another condition to explain.

That reversal is what makes the case public in meaning even while it remains mine in fact. The danger is not that everyone would write my sentence. The danger is that a low-trust system can first exclude a capable person, then use his breaking point to explain away the system that excluded him.

The system was not an independent creature hovering above the country. People made it each morning. A legislator accepted speed. A professional protected a professional habit. An office defended the edge of its competence. A lawyer ran out of time. An expert preferred a total explanation. A judge narrowed the next question. Each choice could look ordinary from inside one role. Placed in sequence, the ordinary choices became the machine.

That does not make every participant cruel, or every Hungarian participant the same. It removes the comforting fiction that a broken system exists without human maintenance. No single person designed the entire corridor. Responsibility moved away from every desk; accountability moved toward the person with nowhere further to send it.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Six — A Private Case Enters Public Time



19. The Streets Begin to Speak

I did not join the KATA protest in 2022. Other citizens were already teaching the city a different language: teachers, students and parents formed chains; the presidential-pardon scandal filled public spaces; judges and court employees later rallied for judicial independence and the freedom to speak.

By then emergency had become an ordinary political grammar. During COVID-19, a curfew decided when a person could cross his own street. As the pandemic order receded, the war next door supplied another state of danger. In 2025, the capital's mayor announced Pride as a city event after the police had prohibited the march. He was questioned, then charged. After the election and a European court judgment, the charge was dropped. The paving stones had not moved. The law around the people on them had.

These movements did not share one programme or know my case. Their cumulative effect was to make institutional operation a public experience.

My own path was quieter and stranger. I moved through electronic forms.

I asked the Hungarian office charged with protecting fundamental rights to look at the police process, the failures of representation and the password-sharing trap. Its answer mapped the limits of its own jurisdiction: it could not review how police and prosecutors weighed the evidence, could not intervene in a pending court process, and directed parts of the complaint back toward the same legal routes already surrounding me. A later answer said that further submissions repeating the issue could be placed in the archive without another reply. An office named for fundamental rights had given me a careful map of the doors it could not open.

A petition to the European Parliament was declared admissible in January 2025. The European Commission response described the data-protection framework and pointed enforcement back toward national authorities and courts. The private file

had entered a legitimate public channel, only to be routed back toward the same national architecture.

I had not become a politician.

I had become impossible to keep entirely private.

20. The Programme Hidden Inside the Complaint

The clemency request contained the sentence toward which all the other pages had been moving:

> *The strength of a state governed by law is revealed in the moments when it can recognize that an individual's failure is, in fact, a reflection of a system failure.*

It did not say that the individual disappears into the system. My sentence remained mine. It said that responsibility becomes dishonest when the last visible error is detached from the machinery that made it likely and then used to absolve that machinery from examination.

Over time, my proposals acquired a structure:

- notify the person directly when a representative acts;
- replace password sharing with granular authorization and acceptance;
- make every filing, rejection and correction visible as one event chain;
- record important outbound calls;
- create a health-crisis pause without erasing obligations;

- simplify tax categories around invoice data where possible;
- let the administration prepare a proposed return rather than force every small worker to reconstruct data the administration already holds;
- strengthen worker protection so that a nominal enterprise route is not the price of employment;
- introduce new tax systems in parallel, test them, then retire the old path;
- use AI to categorize and explain, not to hide responsibility behind another opaque decision.

Later, I remembered a public sentence about KATA-contracted software teams, even inside the tax authority. For a moment, the state and the people it had placed under suspicion appeared to have been buying labour through the same door. Then the door was closed from inside, and the people outside were asked to account for having used it.

The important change was personal. I had moved from demanding that somebody repair my account to asking how the next person could avoid entering the account in the first place.

That is political in the broad sense, but it did not begin with a party.

21. Four Years Later

On 12 April 2026, Hungary voted for a change of government.

The new majority could alter institutions that had appeared fixed. It promised rule of law, judicial independence, anti-corruption and restored public trust; critics warned that rapid constitutional change could reproduce the weakness it claimed to repair. Trust cannot be restored merely by changing who controls the speed.

In July, the former governing party marched under the words *Stop Autocracy* and accused the new majority of dismantling constitutional democracy. The warning might still be right. The same words had crossed the chamber.

The election was not a verdict in my case. It did show that continuity no longer commanded enough trust. Institutions presented as fixed were now being judged by the public beneath them.

One sentence from my 2022 messages acquired an uncanny echo. Its language about twenty years and the rule of law had looked detached from ordinary political possibility. Four years later, public actors were openly describing a change of regime and restoration of the rule of law.

It was not prophecy. It was irony powerful enough to make time feel badly edited.

22. Two Letters to Venice

The constitutional conflict eventually reached the Venice Commission.

The President of the Republic asked the Commission to assess the attempt to end his mandate. His questions were dated 29 May and supplemented on 4 June 2026. He argued from the position of the highest office at risk.

At 14:18 on 5 June, I sent my own submission to the same institution. Seventy-eight minutes later, I forwarded the same letter to the Presidential Palace and the Prime Minister's press office.

It was one small push from below.

The President defended the constitutional security of his office. I asked what constitutional insecurity felt like beneath such offices: tax administration, police procedure, forensic interpretation, clemency and years of uncertainty.

In July, a Venice Commission delegation met the country's senior leadership. Public reporting showed consultation and caution, not a final opinion before Parliament acted. The institution had received warnings from above and below while Hungary's constitutional order stood visibly between states.

23. When an Eighth Judge Steps Aside

Venice was not the President's only route.

On 11 June, he turned to the Constitutional Court for an interpretation of the limits around constitutional amendment and removal. The request returned him to the institution he had joined as a judge in 2014 and led from 2016 until he became

President in 2024. The Court had fifteen members. Seven initially declared that they were personally and directly affected and excluded themselves from the matter. After that was communicated, an eighth judge also declared exclusion.

The full sitting needed ten.

With only seven available, the Court could not form the quorum required to hear the matter, and it disappeared from the agenda before a substantive decision.

The judges had not left office; a majority had stepped out of one case. Yet the body asked to resolve a constitutional conflict could not assemble inside it.

This occurred while my own writings were trying to reach constitutional review from below.

At one scale stood a President and a Court unable to assemble. At the other stood one citizen, a laptop and an AI assistant translating lived chaos into a legal route. Their authority was radically different; both images contained the distance between a constitutional question and an answer.

The Constitutional Court had received my complaint through the trial court, then stopped before the substance because the criminal case had not produced a first-instance decision. The President's case lacked judges. Mine had reached the constitutional door before ordinary procedure had finished with me.

Different cases had reached the same architectural fact: having a constitutional question does not guarantee a room in which anyone will answer it.

24. The Convoy and the List of Offices

After the election, the new Prime Minister publicly called for the departure of officials appointed to long terms across the judiciary, prosecution and oversight bodies. The detailed list belongs in the notes.

The list showed how power can survive an election through long appointments, boards, rules, foundations and institutional habits.

One affair gave that transfer of power a physical image.

On 5 March, two armoured cash-in-transit vehicles travelling from Austria toward Ukraine were stopped near Budapest carrying foreign currency and gold. The scene made instant political cinema.

After the election, the shipment was returned, expulsions were withdrawn and reviews began. A senior prosecutor resigned citing disagreement over the investigation; tax-investigation leaders lost their appointments; the Prosecutor General later resigned. The notes preserve the distinctions. What reached my room was the speed of reversal.

The country could reopen a major enforcement operation, review agencies and move senior offices in weeks. My own proceeding, built around one line and a repaired tax return, had not reached a first judgment in years.

Speed did not make every replacement just. The institutions moved through different legal hinges, and personnel change could still outrun repair.

The correct image is not a row of heads falling in one cut.

It is a wall of institutional portraits, each moving on a different hinge while one person below them refreshes a screen and still does not know what will happen at his next hearing.

25. The Empty Presidential Chair

On 18 July 2026, the President signed the constitutional amendment that ended his own mandate on 20 July.

The parliamentary Speaker became interim President. As this edition closed on 8 August 2026, a new President had not yet been elected.

The empty chair was not a verdict in my case. It belonged to a country that had decided continuity was no longer enough. It also carried a private irony.

I had already asked that office for mercy when mercy itself had become politically dangerous. In February 2024, the disclosure of a presidential pardon connected to the concealment of abuse in a children's home ended one presidency and the public career of the former justice minister who had countersigned it. The next President inherited a power that had burned the hands of the people who used it before him.

I had never treated the person above that office as incidental. In November 2025, I came close to withdrawing my request because I did not consider its occupant fit to decide it. I let the request continue.

The figures made caution almost absolute. In 2025, four of 689 decided applications received clemency. In the first half of 2026, all 314 decisions were refusals. Mine was dated 30 April.

On 19 May, while the same President still held office, I submitted revised papers and asked that they be left with the incoming Justice Minister until the presidency changed. Then I would ask again.

He had refused my clemency. The new majority refused him political mercy.

Before that refusal, the clemency process carried the same questions into my home. A probation officer rang the bell without an appointment. The flat had not been staged for inspection. It was puritan, untidy and unclean that day. I own no

car, usually do not heat the flat in winter, and spend little because that is how I preserve independence. I can live that way. I was not asking the visitor to pity me.

The officer asked what I lived on, why I was not working and what the apartment said about my life, called it a *bachelor flat*, referred to the proposed suspended sentence and reacted with astonishment at the disputed line. A life designed to need very little was once again being read as a condition to be explained.



Security built abroad so he could live at home now felt legible to the file.

One constitutional task of the President is to express the unity of the nation. While Parliament prepared to choose a new person for that chair, I was moving in the opposite emotional direction. I had begun to consider whether leaving Hungary for good might also mean renouncing my Hungarian citizenship.

I had returned from London because I wanted to live in my own country. The fact that I could now imagine giving up the legal bond to it measured the distance between national unity as an office and belonging as a lived experience. I had not completed that act. The thought itself was the measure.

Exile usually means distance from home. I was living at home and felt exiled from it.

Whether the replacement deserves trust depends on how it treats the same problems when speed, power and inconvenience become its own.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Part Seven — The System We Build Instead



26. The Product Returns

The real face of a system is not the front page of its portal or the sentence in which it promises service. It appears when a person says: *the record is wrong; the professional route failed; my body cannot meet your timetable; I need somebody to carry the context from this room into the next one.*

By then, the state had begun to resemble the worst kind of relationship.

It had not been beside me while I searched for work, built independence abroad, returned home, developed the product, secured the Belgian contract, repaired the tax return or recovered alone from surgery. It appeared at the fracture. It took the sentence, the devices, the fingerprints, the expert label and the financial inventory. It claimed authority over the bad while contributing almost nothing to the good. The relationship did not support. It extracted.

The danger did not require a secret conspiracy. It was already present in the architecture: responsibility without shared information, delegated action without safe identity, accusation without complete context, expertise without a whole biography, delay without an ending and financial scrutiny before the systemic cause had been answered. Built that way, a system could humiliate a person, turn his own history against him, threaten the assets that allowed him to survive and make departure feel safer than belonging. It could do this to anyone unlucky enough to enter the same sequence.

For years, MyScoutee had asked how the natural first distrust between strangers could soften without reducing either person to a verdict. It tried to create enough private, reciprocal context for a real meeting to change the first frame.

The legal story returned the question in a harsher form. The institution classified first, and the whole person then had to fight his way back into the record. Here the two lines met.

What should a system preserve before it classifies a person?

Direct notice. Visible actions. Consent that can be withdrawn. A record of who did what. A route to correction. Private context rather than public humiliation. Reciprocal evidence rather than one unanswerable score. Enough human space for the next meeting to change the meaning of the previous one.

A healthy relationship is present in the good as well as the bad. A legitimate system should meet the same minimum test. It cannot abandon the person during work, illness and repair, then arrive only to punish the breaking point and claim the life built without it.

MyScoutee cannot repair a tax authority, court or constitution. A social product also has its own capacity for harm. Ratings can become gossip. Automation can become coercion. Matching can hide a judgment inside a number. Local operators can become unaccountable if the shared core provides no meaningful exit.

The lesson of Part II is therefore not that my product already contains the answer.

It is that the product must survive the question.

27. Humour Is a Human Audit Trail

There is one quality no event log can fully capture.

In rooms where my future was being discussed, I sometimes made people smile. The police uniform remained. The judge remained the judge. I remained the defendant. Nothing procedural changed.

Yet the smile recorded that the roles were not the whole people.

Humour was not disrespect for the seriousness of the case. It was an informal audit trail of humanity: proof only that, for one second, several people could see the absurdity together.

The word was not added years later to make the story more literary. In one 2024 submission, I wrote that the frightening part was in the absurdity. In another, I wrote that if everything had worked lawfully, I believed nothing would have happened.

The humour also appeared in writing and images. I called myself “KATA's most wanted,” turning the tax acronym and the accusation into the title of a farce. In a Hulk-like image, a furious KATA figure held an axe in each hand while the tax authority, prosecution and court hung from his belt. A Hungarian pun changed *the reaper* into *the KATA taxpayer*.

Police recruitment posters supplied another impossible route. On 4 January 2024, I sent the police career office an English curriculum vitae (CV) and an inquiry saying that I had applied for the impossible position being administered at the station, had reached the third round and was still waiting for feedback. I asked for the earliest possible response. The accusation could progress through rounds while the person inside it could not obtain an answer.

Later, asking German police to help the unresponsive Hungarian route extended the same joke beyond the border. The humour was black because the need beneath it was real. In a low-trust process, sarcasm became an unofficial receipt: a way to record that a person had asked for contact when the official relationship would not reliably acknowledge him.

The joke did not deny that some sentences were dangerous. It denied the solemn fiction that the file's language was the only possible description of what had happened. When officers struggled not to laugh, the laughter did not acquit me. It briefly admitted that the institutional character and the human being were not the same person.

In one police submission, I ended by declaring the institution fired. Elsewhere, I sent institutions away to dispense justice in a pasture. A programmer with no power to dismiss the state was dismissing the state in prose. Years later, an election was followed by public demands for long-serving office-holders to leave. The old joke acquired timing it could not have planned.

None of these lines transferred authority or predicted a legal result. Their point was the impossibility. When every office could redirect me but I could redirect none of them, sarcasm briefly reversed the arrows.

Humanity had not vanished from the rooms. It appeared in an embarrassed smile, the second expert's different reaction, a lawyer asking for another room, a judge's changing expression and even my inconvenient attraction while my fingerprints were taken. The cruelty lay partly in the failure to carry those moments forward. Every person could remain human locally while the combined process behaved as though nobody were.

Normal conditions might have prevented the error chain. A measured transition, clear authority, direct notice, one coherent record and a body given time to recover could have left no criminal story to tell.

Instead, the system assembled a tragedy with comic timing.

28. The Invitation Changes

Part I ended by asking people to test MyScoutee in real communities.

Part II ends with a harder invitation.

Test the systems between us before pressure tests them for us.

The test is not whether a system can find an individual error. Every system can do that. The test is whether it can still recognize itself in the error after the individual has been found.

Do not wait for the frightened taxpayer, isolated worker, exhausted accountant, overloaded official, defendant or judge to reveal every missing connection at the worst possible moment.

Design the notification. Show the delegated act. Preserve the correction. Keep the human being larger than the score. Let people leave a network without leaving their dignity inside it.

I began this period as a programmer trying to remain legal and finish a foreign contract.

I ended it—if this can yet be called an ending—sending institutional designs to a government I had not helped elect as an activist, during a constitutional transition I could not have planned.

Between those two moments, the proceeding moved from words on a screen to the material remains of Part I: the apartment my parents had helped provide, the belongings inside it, and savings built principally through work abroad. I had returned because Budapest costs made the independence earned in London usable. Now I felt that the price of trying foreign remote work from home might reach back and consume the independence that had made the attempt possible.

The next hearing was scheduled for 16 September 2026. The new justice administration had replied only that my submission was being forwarded for handling. The country had an interim President. The final legal result did not exist.

An older Hungarian instruction remained available: *strive, and trust*. I no longer heard it as passive faith in authority. I heard it as the right to try again, to look back from another world, and to ask whether home—and I—could do better.

The line remains open.

MyScoutee. Test the system between us.



MYSCOUTEE SYSTEM STORY

Notes on Evidence, Context, and the Open Ending



How to use these notes

The memoir has already established its point of view. These notes keep the legal and documentary background available without interrupting the story.

Private people remain anonymous. The two forensic experts are separate people. No final confiscation, financial penalty or criminal judgment is asserted. Political change supplies public context; it does not decide the pending case or clinically resolve a contested expert opinion.

The legal links below are orientation points, not a substitute for advice. A lawyer should match every proposed argument to the law in force on the relevant date, the exact charge, the filed submissions and the complete procedural record.

The charging document is a prosecution position, not a neutral biography or a judgment. In the Founder's reading, it organizes the sequence so that the institutional failures become background while legal causation and responsibility narrow around the individual. That is a defence interpretation of the document's architecture, not a finding that the prosecution concealed a proved institutional cause or that the court accepted the interpretation.

The evidence-reconstruction passage in Chapter 14 is grounded in the defence speech and the private investigation evidence bundle listed in the internal source inventory. The defence speech lists missing electronic submissions, tax-authority call recordings and the call history recovered from the returned phone as material the Founder gathered after finding the investigative selection distorted. Letters reproduced in the bundle record requests made through the tax authority's Central Directorate, the staged release of recordings, delayed delivery and the later supply of electronic submissions after an acknowledged administrative error. The defence speech records that the Founder forwarded the recovered material and that police later requested material again. The narrative therefore describes the Founder performing the first reconstruction before the authority repeated the request

through its own channel. This supports the sequence of the search; it does not establish that an official deliberately deleted evidence, deliberately waited for the Founder or that every missing call had been recorded.

The fundamental-rights passage in Chapter 19 refers to Hungary's Commissioner for Fundamental Rights, not the European Ombudsman. Letters in the same private bundle describe jurisdictional limits over police evidence assessment, prosecutorial activity and pending court proceedings, and state that further repetitive submissions could be archived without another reply. The later European Parliament petition and Commission response form a separate route. The memoir may let their proximity carry institutional irony, but it does not merge the offices or claim that either decided the criminal case.

The preparatory-hearing notice dated 6 May 2025 explains that the accused may admit guilt and waive trial in the admitted part, or present defence facts, evidence and exclusion requests; it also allows agreed facts to be accepted without further proof. Section 316 of the Criminal Code sets a range of two to eight years for the charged offence. The Founder records that the prosecution proposed the statutory minimum of two years, suspended, in exchange for admission and waiver. The offer and the Founder's understanding of the room are memoir layers until the complete preparatory-hearing record is isolated.

The facts, position and decisions in the two-page speech were the Founder's; an AI assistant already helped shape that first filing. The later defence speech in the reviewed package is approximately eight pages and was developed through the same human–AI process. The Founder recalls that appointed counsel asked him to bring defence material on a pen drive and forwarded a hearing invitation on which the clerk's email address remained visible. Before he knew the court's electronic filing system, that address enabled the last-minute email filing. These details describe the practical route and the limited assistance he experienced; they do not establish counsel's private intention. The same private account records resource-based refusals from two Hungarian human-rights organizations and a later private-lawyer consultation, including the two-million-forint-plus-VAT quotation

and the Founder's memory of how quickly the psychiatric label entered the conversation. The lawyer remains anonymous; the book does not use a private consultation to make a professional finding about her.

Section 44 of the Criminal Procedure Act makes participation by defence counsel mandatory where the offence carries imprisonment of five years or more. A lawyer, not an AI system, must fill that legal role. The memoir's Trojan-horse image records the Founder's experience of a compulsory but discontinuous relationship; it is not a finding that appointed counsel colluded with the judge, breached a professional duty or represented the institution instead of the accused.

The discontinuity is not based only on a later impression. The defence speech and private investigation bundle record a trainee appearing at the first questioning, a succession of appointed lawyers, periods without accessible contact, withdrawal or release requests, and the Founder's complaint that later defenders' contact details had not been supplied. The Commissioner for Fundamental Rights summarized the same complaint as involving several appointed defenders, an initial defender who did not speak to him and missing contact information for later appointments. Private names are omitted from the memoir. The records do not by themselves establish professional misconduct by every lawyer or a coordinated institutional purpose.

The Chapter 14 complaint route combines the Founder's filed account and the reviewed correspondence: he called police, prosecution and court contacts, used electronic judicial submission routes, complained to court administration and the prosecution hierarchy, and sought help from the fundamental-rights office. The separate judiciary-administration complaint in the private bundle is addressed to Hungary's National Office for the Judiciary; it is not relabelled as a decision of the National Judicial Council. The recurring image of a future complaint, appeal, lawsuit or Strasbourg application replacing present correction is the memoir's synthesis of those routes. It is not a finding that any named official consciously chose to violate a rule because later litigation was available.

- Hungarian Criminal Code, section 316 and the two-to-eight-year statutory range: https://njt.hu/jogszabaly/2012-100-00-00.31

- Hungarian Criminal Procedure Act, section 44 on mandatory defence: https://njt.hu/jogszabaly/2017-90-00-00.13
- Fundamental Law of Hungary, Article II on inviolable human dignity: https://njt.hu/jogszabaly/2011-4301-02-00

The exclusion filing dated 5 April 2026 and its 8 April annex are present in the private package. The annex asks for an official audio recording of the hearings, the accountant and a tax-administration representative to be heard, and the outstanding 8 April evidentiary requests to be carried out. It records the Founder's account that a clerk had described official recording as expensive. The 5 April filing itself quotes the judge's question in Hungarian. The chapter renders its spoken force in English as “What—are you asking to be sent to prison?” rather than using the legalistic “custodial sentence.” The clerk's startled reaction when the apartment was mentioned is memoir; it is not presented as a quotation from those filings.

The separate ruling arrived by post and remains in my possession. It rejected exclusion, warned about a possible fine, relayed the challenged judge's claim that she had listened to me conscientiously, said that each party could present its position and referred to a future Strasbourg route. It left the requests for official audio, witnesses and outstanding evidence unanswered.

Strasbourg means the European Court of Human Rights, an institution of the Council of Europe rather than the European Union. Its official guidance treats the Court as a safety net after available domestic remedies have been exhausted; the current general time limit is four months from the final domestic decision. The memoir's minefield image is an account of how that principle felt inside this proceeding, not legal advice that the domestic route is already exhausted or that an application would be admissible.

- Council of Europe, how the Convention system works: https://www.coe.int/en/web/impact-convention-human-rights/how-it-works
- European Court of Human Rights, admissibility and the four-month rule: https://www.echr.coe.int/en/videos

- European Court of Human Rights, Article 13 guide on an effective remedy: https://ks.echr.coe.int/documents/d/echr-ks/guide_art_13_eng-pdf
- Council of Europe, distinction from the European Union: https://www.coe.int/en/web/portal/eu-accession-echr-questions-and-answers

The primary record

This edition was reconstructed from a private source inventory containing tax and portal evidence, authored submissions, the charge, a forensic report, correspondence, product screenshots and a bounded set of private recordings.

The surviving recordings contain little of the decisive sequence. Their value is atmospheric: the calls they preserve are ordinary and non-threatening, not the menacing scene that later institutional language might suggest. The key exchanges survive through the defence speech, later submissions and the events that followed.

The four direct remarks in Chapter 6 are close English translations of the Hungarian wording preserved in the signed defence speech. The decisive calls do not survive in the reviewed recording set, so the book attributes the words to that later written record rather than presenting them as an independently verified transcript.

The Founder also records that he made an undisclosed audio recording when he collected the investigation material alone on 11 June 2024. This edition does not quote or publish that private audio and does not decide its admissibility or lawfulness. Its narrative use is narrower: it shows how far trust in a shared institutional account had already collapsed.

The public-interest material contains two related but distinct source lines. The first is the constructive system proposal of 1 December 2022 described in Chapter 7. It begins the design line: direct notice, visible delegated action, granular

authority, an auditable correction chain, health-crisis handling and safer tax transitions.

The second is a five-page authored document dated 30 October 2025 and titled *Public-Interest Action*. Its cover deliberately reverses the ordinary positions: the Hungarian State is placed in the position of the accused and the Founder in the position representing the accusation. It organizes the argument under five headings: constitutional injury, data-protection injury, public-portal failures, criminal procedure and moral redress. Its final proposal imagines a KATA film fund whose cultural proceeds would support ecological restoration.

The reviewed root PDF is marked version 8; a separately signed copy is marked version 5. Their wording differs in places. Both are authored advocacy. The title alone does not establish that a court accepted the document under that procedural classification or decided its merits. The later European petition and the wider GDPR/taxation petition are separate source families again.

The raw package is not published with the book because it contains identifiers, private third-party data, medical-adjacent material and unresolved allegations.

Several black-comedy details have a firmer documentary layer than their tone might suggest. A 4 January 2024 email to the police career office attaches an English CV and describes the investigation as an impossible position whose third round has produced no feedback. An authored English submission dated 17 April records outreach to German police and German/Belgian press. A clemency submission records a further police report about the interrupted orthodontic treatment on the day before the home search. These records support the dates and the Founder's own language. They do not prove that the dental report caused the search, that a foreign authority assumed jurisdiction or that any officer accepted the satire's interpretation.

A 7 April 2024 submission records the reaction when the Founder raised the password-sharing problem and preserves the judgment that he had done something stupid. The scene in Chapter 11 gives the lived exchange; the filing supplies its documentary trace.

The reviewed submissions document questions about income and financial position, refer to the apartment and record the Founder's reliance on London savings and Hungarian government-bond returns. In the hearing, the apartment did not end the inquiry: the questions continued through the belongings inside it, the bond account, the savings and what else he owned. No confiscation or final financial penalty had been ordered at the time of publication.

The constitutional complaint carried two arguments developed in the defence: the conflict between routine password sharing and European data protection, including the GDPR, and the absence of adequate preparation time after the rapid KATA transition. A two-page Constitutional Court letter dated 21 October 2025 records that the complaint had arrived through the trial court on 18 October while the criminal case was still pending. It treated the section 27 route as premature. The exceptional direct route under section 26(2) had also run into the 180-day limit in section 30. Neither underlying question received a merits answer.

The first assigned judge left after reported illness. The April 2026 exclusion filing concerned the next assigned judge. A separate judge rejected the request as unfounded and warned of a possible procedural fine. The paper ruling remains in the Founder's possession.

The signed defence speech explicitly records the password paradox. Its account of a tax-administration callback includes both a challenge to the Founder for sharing his government-account password and an assurance that another accountant could work without it. The same speech later argues that, within the system then actually used, the immediate chaos could have been avoided only if the accountant had not merely received the password but had consistently used that same account for the work, allowing the critical notices to reach the Founder. An earlier ombudsman submission describes three theoretical working arrangements and the visibility gap that remained when representation and the Founder's own inbox were separated. These are the Founder's documented account and system argument, not a finding by the court.

The post-operative-leg image and the vulgar physical-comedy description are supported by authored defence material. The pasture image is presently a memoir-layer recollection and is paraphrased rather than presented as a verified quotation.

The further post-operative profanity—rendered in literary English as “Go on, then. Fine me.”—is also kept at memoir layer. The wider March–May submission period is documented, but the exact page containing that remembered wording has not yet been isolated from the scanned monthly bundles. The narrative therefore uses the line to mark collapsed trust rather than presenting it as a verified quotation. It was addressed to the institution as a whole, not to an individual official or any relative.

The 2019–2021 employment thresholds

The long idle periods, suspected circulation of the smaller company's negative assessment, work repeatedly routed elsewhere, shared-storefront role, ten subsidiaries, different marketing incentives, later senior-office conversations and the Founder's interpretation of the COVID-19 dismissal are memoir. The book does not claim that office gossip existed as fact, that the programme had no legitimate purpose, or that a particular manager or business interest caused the dismissal. Those details explain how an apparently stable salaried role felt from the desk before it ended. The stronger severance payment, colleagues' surprise, relatively humane separation and the Founder's experience of the loss as tragedy are also memoir; no confidential amount or contractual entitlement is asserted.

The later fourth-round multinational interview, former supervisor's personal connection with one leader and his intervention are also memoir. The Founder believes that intervention contributed to the rejection, but has no decision record proving motive or causation. The company remains unnamed. This passage therefore shows another gate closing in a COVID-19-constricted search; it does not make an employment-discrimination or improper-influence finding.

Private recruitment correspondence records an intended January 2021 start and an exit email dated 28 January. Later correspondence with the Hungarian central bank records the short employment, the government-bond trading restriction and the Founder's data-handling and background-screening complaints. The long assessment and requirement that screening clear before the start are first-person employment chronology. The exact first-day warning, masked-room expressions, seating of two colleagues, exit question and roughly three-hour ethics conversation with the bank's local lawyers remain first-person memory. The Founder also records that he answered “no” when repeatedly asked whether the manager had threatened him, and now regards that answer as incomplete. The book does not determine the purpose or independence of the internal review, make a legal finding about the manager or bank, or claim that a later unresolved proceeding has already produced a criminal-record outcome. His indifference to the bank dismissal describes his burned-out internal state, not the objective seriousness of the employment decision.

The official issuance terms for the retail Hungarian government bond described domestic and foreign natural persons as eligible subscribers and the public as its target market. This explains the Founder's household-savings perspective; it does not decide whether the bank's employee-trading policy was lawful, proportionate or required. In January 2021, Hungary's public rules included a 20:00–05:00 curfew, a ban on gatherings, early shop closure and broad mask requirements. The particular masked dismissal room remains memoir.

- Hungarian retail government-bond issuance terms: https://www.allampapir.hu/ismerteto/M%C3%81P%20Plusz%20Ismertet%C5%91%202019.11.04-t%C5%91l%20hat%C3%A1lyos.pdf
- Government Decree 484/2020 on the protective rules then in force: https://njt.jog.gov.hu/jogszabaly/2020-484-20-22.24

Legal reference map

The tax transition and the low-trust triangle

- Act CXLVII of 2012 on the former KATA and small-business tax regime
- Act XIII of 2022 on the new itemized tax for small taxpayers
- Official explanatory memorandum to Act XIII of 2022
- Constitutional Court Decision 29/2022 (XII. 6.) on challenges to the KATA change
- Act CL of 2017 on the Rules of Taxation
- Act CLI of 2017 on Tax Administration Procedure

These texts frame the tax status, transition, taxpayer responsibility, representation, communication and administrative principles around which the documentary dispute developed. The exact notice path and filing history still have to be reconstructed from the account-specific record; the statutes alone do not answer who saw which message when.

Procedure, defence and expert evidence

- Act C of 2012, the Hungarian Criminal Code
- Act XC of 2017 on Criminal Procedure
- Act XXIX of 2016 on Forensic Experts
- Act CLI of 2011 on the Constitutional Court, including the routes discussed in sections 25–27
- The Fundamental Law of Hungary, especially the rule-of-law, privacy, fair-administration, fair-trial and remedy provisions that appear in the submissions

The exact offence, statutory range, defence route and requested remedy must be read from the charge and filed papers. This book does not infer them from the headline name of an offence.

Data, identity and European guarantees

- Regulation (EU) 2016/679, the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), particularly the principles of processing, transparency, access, security and remedies
- Act CXII of 2011 on Informational Self-Determination and Freedom of Information
- Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union, including dignity, private life, personal data, good administration, an effective remedy and fair-trial guarantees, subject to the Charter's scope
- European Convention on Human Rights, particularly Articles 6 and 8
- European Commission 2025 Rule of Law Report and country material

These instruments explain why identity-sharing, delegated action, accessible records, personal data, home, reputation, defence and effective remedies can become more than software-design questions. They do not by themselves prove a breach in this case.

The government account and the later two-factor change

The “government account” in the narrative was Hungary's **Citizen Portal** identification service. In 2022, the relevant login was based on a username and password. From 16 January 2025, access to the same public-service surfaces required either the two-factor Citizen Portal Plus method or the Digital Citizenship application. This later security change does not rewrite the 2022 scene.

Official guidance for accountants describes using another person's Citizen Portal identity instead of acting as an authorized representative as a bad, legally problematic practice. It points to registered authorization and the Hungarian tax administration's (NAV's) representation form as the lawful alternative. That is an identity boundary; it does not, by itself, resolve the separate visibility problem in the Founder's record: who received each submission result and notice, and whether both sides could see the same chain.

Citizen Portal Plus installs a secret into an authenticator through a setup quick-response (QR) code and then generates time-limited login codes from that secret. It follows technically that copying the setup QR to another device can duplicate the second factor. That inference explains why photographing a setup code may be used as a workaround, but it is neither secure delegation nor an officially endorsed accounting practice. Two-factor authentication protects a login; it does not turn shared identity into granular authorization.

Official sources:

- Hungarian government English-language description of the Citizen Portal and the 16 January 2025 transition: https://baku.mfa.gov.hu/en/citizen-portal-ugyfelkapuugyfelkapu
- Digital Citizenship Programme guidance for accountants and tax advisers, including the distinction between shared identity and authorized representation: https://platform.dap.gov.hu/tajekoztatok/tajekoztato-konyveloknek-es-adoszakertoknek-az-ugyfelkapu-kivezeteserol.pdf
- National Cyber Security Institute explanation of the authenticator secret, setup QR and time-based codes: https://nki.gov.hu/it-biztonsag/tanacsok/igy-teheto-biztonsagosabba-az-ugyfelkapus-bejelentkezes/

The functioning-system counterfactual in Chapter 5 is not a ranking of countries. It is supported by official examples of delegation that keep the agent's identity separate from the taxpayer's login. British guidance expressly tells agents not to use a client's credentials and provides client authorization routes. Finland offers tax-specific electronic mandates, and Estonia provides identifiable access permissions for representatives. The details differ, and none guarantees competent service. They demonstrate that representation need not require shared identity.

- The United Kingdom's tax authority, HM Revenue & Customs, authorizing an agent through a business tax account: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/authorise-an-agent-for-certain-taxes-through-your-business-tax-account

- Finnish Tax Administration, Suomi.fi authorizations for tax matters: https://www.vero.fi/en/About-us/contact-us/efil/authorisations/
- Estonian Tax and Customs Board, granting and terminating access through its e-MTA online tax service: https://www.emta.ee/en/business-client/e-services-training-courses/how-use-e-services/granting-and-termination-access

Clemency social inquiry

The Founder's application reached a clemency institution already transformed by the 2024 presidential-pardon scandal. The President resigned after the pardon became public. The former justice minister whose countersignature had made the decision effective withdrew from public life. The next President subsequently described clemency as an exceptional power and promised greater transparency.

Official presidential statistics record four grants among 689 decided cases in 2025 and no grants among 314 decided cases in the first half of 2026. The Founder's private record dates his refusal to 30 April 2026. The figures establish the rarity of clemency in this period; they do not establish the unrecorded reasoning behind an individual decision.

A signed private filing dated 19 May 2026 records that the Founder had nearly withdrawn the application in November 2025 because he did not consider the incumbent President suitable to decide it. The same filing asks that revised papers be held by the incoming Justice Minister until the presidency changed, after which the Founder intended to submit the request again. The public narrative leaves the minister unnamed; the filing supplies the role and date.

Hungarian procedural rules identify the person preparing a social inquiry for an ordinary procedural-clemency request as a probation officer. The inquiry may describe personal, family, health, housing, employment, income and property

circumstances. It is evidence assembled for the clemency file; the probation officer does not decide the request or sentence.

Official sources:

- Presidential Palace, presidential interview on the clemency practice and the constitutional role of expressing national unity: https://www.sandorpalota.hu/hu/tarsadalmi-beke-megteremteseert-dolgozom-mandiner-interjuja-dr-sulyok-tamas-koztarsasagi-elnokkel
- Presidential Palace, clemency statistics for 2025: https://www.sandorpalota.hu/sites/default/files/2026-01/Kegyelmi%20statisztika_2025.pdf
- Presidential Palace, clemency statistics for the first half of 2026: https://www.sandorpalota.hu/sites/default/files/2026-06/Kegyelmi%20statisztika%202026.01.01-2026.06.30.pdf
- Euronews, contemporary account of the Novák resignation and Varga countersignature: https://hu.euronews.com/2024/02/10/novak-varga-pedofil-kegyelem-lemond-orban-ellenzek
- National Legislation Database, explanatory material for Decree 12/2022: https://njt.hu/jogszabaly/2022-12-K3-06
- National Legislation Database, probation-service rules: https://njt.hu/jogszabaly/2013-8-20-2T

The absence of prior notice is recorded in the Founder's clemency submission. The condition of the flat, the visitor's reactions and the remembered reference to a proposed suspended sentence remain attributed memoir unless the completed social inquiry is isolated from the private archive.

KATA

Public reporting supports the exceptional speed of the July 2022 legislative change, the 1 September transition and the protests. The Founder did not attend the protest and does not claim that all KATA use was identical.

The Hungarian National Bank's October 2022 public-finance report described roughly 450,000 KATA taxpayers before the change, with only 100,000–150,000 expected to remain eligible.

A private email dated 8 August 2026 records the Founder's recollection of a public remark about KATA-contracted software teams, including teams inside the tax authority. The underlying public recording has not yet been isolated. The book therefore uses it as a remembered public sentence, not as a verified quotation or independent proof of the authority's staffing arrangements. Its narrative function is narrower: the state could use the same distorted labour route whose users later carried the burden of its abrupt closure.

Sources:

- https://telex.hu/english/2022/07/12/major-tax-change-bill-pushed-through-parliament-in-spite-of-protests
- https://telex.hu/english/2022/07/18/president-novak-signs-new-tax-law
- https://www.mnb.hu/letoltes/mnb-public-finance-report-2022-october.pdf

Formal rules and lived practice

The memoir uses *low trust* to describe the repeated gap between what the rule said, what people informally did to make work possible and who carried the risk when the two routes separated. It is not offered as a diagnosis of Hungarian character. Scholarship on Hungary and other post-socialist societies provides the background distinction: formal institutions cannot be understood without the practices, narratives and informal rules through which people actually use them.

Other research cautions against treating informal adaptation as evidence of moral inferiority; it can be a response to organizational hierarchy, scarcity and weak institutional trust.

These sources inform the narrative architecture. They do not prove the facts of the private case or make every Hungarian institution equivalent.

- *Informal Institutional Elements as Both Preconditions and Consequences of Effective Formal Legal Rules: The Failure of Constitutional Institution Building in Hungary*: https://academic.oup.com/ajcl/article/68/4/760/6131768
- *Trust and the Politics of Postcommunism*: https://doi.org/10.1016/S0967-067X(00)00002-1
- *Imperatives in Informal Organizational Resource Exchange in Central Europe*: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.euras.2014.10.001

Interpersonal trust, hierarchy and the remote team

The audio-only team, tuk-tuk, private conversations, senior-manager support, colleague's caste remark, death and funeral invitation are first-person memories. They describe one working relationship, not Indian or Hungarian people as fixed national characters.

A 2022 Ipsos online survey supplies limited comparative context: 56 percent of its Indian sample and 19 percent of its Hungarian sample answered that most people could be trusted. Ipsos cautions that its Indian sample was more urban, educated and affluent than the general population. The figures do not prove why this particular team behaved as it did.

Peer-reviewed correspondence research has separately found caste-based discrimination in Indian private-sector callbacks. That evidence makes the colleague's remembered answer socially legible; it does not identify his caste, prove the motive of any manager in this project or turn the team into a case study of India.

- Ipsos, *Interpersonal Trust Across the World* (March 2022): https://www.ipsos.com/sites/default/files/ct/news/documents/2022-03/Global%20Advisor%20-%20Interpersonal%20Trust%202022%20-%20Graphic%20Report_0.pdf
- Zahra Siddique, *Evidence on Caste Based Discrimination*, *Labour Economics* 18 (2011): https://doi.org/10.1016/j.labeco.2011.07.002

Civic and judicial context

The education protests, presidential-pardon demonstrations, judges' rally and other civil-liberties protests are independent public events. They supply the period's institutional atmosphere; they do not prove a direct relationship to the Founder's case.

Sources:

- https://www.euronews.com/2022/11/19/hungary-teachers-protests
- https://apnews.com/article/1c6c96e81c7bec71cb8e62a3cb0c11b1
- https://uk.investing.com/news/world-news/protesters-demand-hungarys-president-quits-over-sex-abuse-case-pardon-3332289
- https://www.investing.com/news/world-news/hungarian-judges-court-staff-rally-for-judicial-independence-3884986
- https://commission.europa.eu/strategy-and-policy/policies/justice-and-fundamental-rights/upholding-rule-law/rule-law/annual-rule-law-cycle/2025-rule-law-report_en

Emergency powers and public reversals

The book joins several public moments to show a political atmosphere, not one continuous legal regime. A COVID-19-era decree imposed a night curfew and broad limits on assembly. A later state of danger was justified through the war in neighbouring Ukraine. These were distinct legal phases; the narrative does not claim that one automatically caused the other.

In 2025, after police prohibited Budapest Pride, the capital's mayor announced it as a municipal event and was later questioned and charged. Reporting in June 2026 records that the prosecution dropped the charge after a Court of Justice of the European Union judgment. The book uses the sequence as a public reversal, not as evidence about the Founder's criminal case.

In July 2026, the former governing party organized a *Stop Autocracy* protest and accused the new majority of dismantling constitutional democracy. That was a political allegation, not a finding that the new government was or was not authoritarian. The narrative retains the image because language once used against the old order had moved to the other side of Parliament.

A February 2025 interview records the justice minister saying that judicial independence was not in danger. Asked in a separate Index interview whether he had tried to persuade the National Judicial Council, Justice Minister Bence Tuzson said:

> *“This is not a Western. We do not operate on the basis of whose arguments hit harder.”*

Later that month, judges and court employees rallied for judicial independence and the freedom to speak.

On 15 March 2025, at the state ceremony marking the 177th anniversary of the Hungarian Revolution and War of Independence of 1848–49, Prime Minister Viktor Orbán said:

> *“After today's ceremony comes the Easter clean-up. The bugs survived the winter.”*

The next sentence began, “We will dismantle the financial machine,” then named politicians, judges, journalists, bogus NGOs and political activists. The passage continued: “We will dismantle the entire shadow army.” Two days later, the National Judicial Council and the Association of Hungarian Judges publicly rejected both the suggestion that judges had been bought with corrupt dollars and the comparison of judges to harmful insects.

A separate 2025 controversy provides another reference-layer example of institutional certainty preceding completed fact-finding. In September, the justice minister presented a report saying that no minor victim had emerged in a children's-home case. In November, he said it still had to be clarified whether a minor had been involved; later proceedings continued to develop the record. This sequence is not part of the Founder's case and is not used to allege a deliberate lie. It is retained only as context for the period's conflict between definitive official language and unfinished facts.

Sources:

- https://njt.jog.gov.hu/jogszabaly/2020-484-20-22.24
- https://kormany.hu/hirek/a-kormanyzati-tajekoztatasi-kozpont-kozlemenye20221028
- https://apnews.com/article/5c4e6ea328c1ab178a9609c918626ed0
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/06/04/karacsony-gergely-budapest-pride-vadejtes-ugyeszseg

- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/07/09/fidesz-stop-onkeny-tuntetes-ader-janos
- https://index.hu/belfold/2025/02/05/tuzson-bence-igazsagszolgaltatas-igazsagugyi-miniszterium-orszagos-birosagi-hivatal-orszagos-biroi-tanacs-kuria-birosag/
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2025/02/05/tuzson-bence-interju-bombariado-till-tamas-obt-beremeles-reform
- https://enbudapestem.hu/2025/02/22/az-igazsagszolgaltatas-fuggetlensegeert-tuntetnek
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GlEbs_Da_hg
- https://hirado.hu/belfold/cikk/2025/03/15/itt-olvashatja-orban-viktor-teljes-unnepi-beszedet
- https://telex.hu/english/2025/03/17/bugs-cockroaches-vermin-how-dehumanising-propaganda-sets-the-stage
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2025/03/17/obt-orszagos-biroi-tanacs-poloska-eliteles
- https://hvg.hu/itthon/20250924_Tuzson-Bence-a-Szolo-utcai-javitointezet-ugyerol-kiskoru-sertett-nem-volt-es-politikusok-neve-sem-kerult-elo
- https://444.hu/2025/11/04/tuzson-bence-tisztazni-kell-volt-e-kiskoru-erintett-a-szolo-utcai-igazgato-ugyeben

Long-term work exclusion

Eurostat defines long-term unemployment at twelve months and very long-term unemployment at twenty-four months. Its definition also distinguishes active unemployment from being outside the labour force. The Founder's approximate “nine of eleven years” therefore remains memoir language for time outside conventional employment, not a claim of nine continuous years in

Eurostat's unemployment category. Longitudinal research is used only as population-level context for scarring, health and re-employment; it is not used to diagnose the Founder.

Sources:

- https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/cache/metadata/en/lfsi_esms.htm
- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/40930969/
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC2741513/
- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/21681454/

The 2026 transition

Independent and official reporting supports the election result, government change, constitutional amendments, end of the President's mandate and interim presidency. The government's restoration account and civil-society criticism are both retained because institutional replacement is not self-validating. The public call for departures named the President, Prosecutor General and the heads of the Constitutional Court, Curia, National Office for the Judiciary, State Audit Office, Competition Authority and Media Authority.

Sources:

- https://apnews.com/article/6207293383e991b96c64e94ef425f10c
- https://apnews.com/article/b720492c8e007468e6a97519f8809394
- https://www.euronews.com/2026/07/18/hungarian-president-tamas-sulyok-signs-constitutional-amendment-ending-his-own-mandate
- https://kormany.hu/hirek/a-kormany-benyujtja-az-orszaggyulesnek-az-alaptorveny-tizenhetedik-modositasat
- https://telex.hu/english/2026/05/12/incoming-hungarian-justice-minister-promises-to-re-establish-the-rule-of-law-and-crack-down-on-corruption

- https://www.hrw.org/news/2026/06/25/hungary-rushed-constitutional-changes-undermine-rule-of-law

The Constitutional Court's seven initial recusals followed by an eighth, the resulting lack of quorum and the separate future departure of four over-seventy judges are distinct events.

Sources:

- https://alkotmanybirosag.hu/a-jelenlegi-tagok/dr-sulyok-tamas/
- https://alkotmanybirosag.hu/aktualis-hirek-esemenyek/
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/06/19/alkotmanybirosag-sulyok-tamas-kizaras-eltavolitas
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/06/19/alkotmanybirosag-polt-peter-sulyok-tamas
- https://hvg.hu/itthon/20260619_sulyok-tamas-beadvany-alkotmanybirosag-ules-alkotmanybiro-kizaras
- https://cms.law/en/hun/legal-updates/hungary-s-parliament-passes-amendment-of-the-constitution

The Ukrainian cash-in-transit affair and institutional departures

The convoy sequence joins a pre-election enforcement operation to later institutional review, but the public record does not support one undifferentiated claim that every departure had the same cause.

The tax authority's 6 March statement records the two vehicles, seven Ukrainian citizens, forty million dollars, thirty-five million euros and nine kilograms of gold. It also records that substantially larger aggregate quantities had already

crossed Hungary in 2026. On 9 July, the authority said its domestic inquiry had found no indication of a crime and was suspended pending an Austrian response; an internal legality and procedure review remained in progress.

The head of the Central Investigative Chief Prosecutor's Office submitted his resignation on 8 June and expressly cited professional disagreements over the convoy case. The Prime Minister later ordered reviews of the authorities and services involved. The tax authority confirmed that two senior investigative leaders lost their appointments on 14 July, while declining to state that the convoy caused those personnel decisions.

The Prosecutor General submitted his resignation on 22 July and requested that his mandate end on 25 August. His formal explanation invoked the interests of the prosecution service. Reporting and political statements placed the convoy inside the pressure surrounding his departure, but that context is not treated as a proved exclusive cause.

Sources:

- https://nav.gov.hu/print/sajtoszoba/hirek/A_Nemzeti_Ado-_es_Vamhivatal_penzmosas_buncselekmeny_gyanujaval_folytat_buntetoeljarast
- https://nav.gov.hu/print/sajtoszoba/hirek/A_NAV_felfuggesztette_a_nyomozast_az_ukran_penzszallito_ugyeben
- https://telex.hu/english/2026/06/03/it-was-orban-who-ordered-the-raid-on-the-ukrainian-cash-transport
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/06/11/lemondott-a-kozponti-nyomozo-fougyeszseg-vezetoje
- https://444.hu/2026/06/17/magyar-peter-azonnali-vizsgalatot-rendelt-el-aranykonvojugyben-a-nav-nal-a-tek-nel-es-az-erintett-szolgalatoknal
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/07/16/nav-vezeto-levaltas-aranykonvoj-ukran-penszallito-eljaras
- https://telex.hu/belfold/2026/07/22/lemondott-a-legfobb-ugyesz

The Venice Commission

The Presidential Palace publication supports the President's questions. The Founder's 5 June email survives in the private source package. Its Gmail export records the 14:18 message to the Commission and the 15:36 forwarding of the same text to the Presidential Palace and the Prime Minister's press office. The Commission's official notice supports the 2 July meetings. No reviewed source proves that the Founder's email caused the Commission's later public posture.

Sources:

- https://www.sandorpalota.hu/sites/default/files/2026-06/Questions%20adressed%20to%20the%20Venice%20Commission_2026_07_06.pdf
- https://www.coe.int/en/web/venice-commission/-/venice-commission-president-concludes-visit-to-hungary
- https://telex.hu/english/2026/07/02/venice-commission-delegation-met-with-both-magyar-and-sulyok-pm-says-no-criticism-of-constitutional-amendment-to-remove-sulyok

Foreign-currency loans and migration

The London housemate is an anonymized first-person memory. European and Hungarian high-court material supports the bounded point that legal consequences of foreign-currency-loan contracts remained under active interpretation in 2025. Migration sources support large outward movement and data limitations, not one universal cause.

Sources:

- https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A62023CJ0630
- https://kuria-birosag.hu/en/uniformity-decisions/operative-part-uniformity-decision-no-102025-jpe
- https://www.ksh.hu/s/publications/vital-events-2021/index.html
- https://www.ksh.hu/docs/eng/seemig/outputs/SEEMIGHistoricalAnalysisHungary.pdf

AI-assisted work and the Navier–Stokes exchange

The closing phrase *strive, and trust* is a concise English rendering of the final imperative in Imre Madách's nineteenth-century dramatic poem *The Tragedy of Man*. The narrative applies it to continued effort and the right to try again, not to unquestioning trust in an institution.

The public repositories show the constructive work discussed in the chapter; they are evidence of scope and method, not proof of any legal or clinical claim.

- MyScoutee product and production repository: https://github.com/fssrepository/myscoutee-backend
- Civic Access public-service prototype: https://github.com/fssrepository/e-kozig

The creative-work chapter is supported by the versioned research repository, the experiment note and the 6 August 2026 email in which a professor working in this field said he had read two supplied documents and the proof plan, found the ideas intriguing and asked which exact mathematical statements were being tested. The Founder's reply made the bridge explicit: published variational searches for

extreme-flow states and tests of inequality sharpness inspired an AI-maintained laboratory that attacks proposed lemmas with counterexample searches before promoting them into human proof obligations.

The proposed cutoff-uniform inequality, the internally labelled PNT-12 target, rejected candidates and partial computational result remain unverified working research. The book does not claim a proof of regularity, finite-time blow-up or a solution of the Clay problem. The episode demonstrates intellectual work, falsification discipline and human–AI handoff under legal uncertainty, not mathematical success by association.

- Public research repository and proof plan: https://github.com/fssrepository/millennium-math-problems
- Research on extreme vortex states and enstrophy growth: https://doi.org/10.1017/jfm.2017.136
- Research on numerical tests of inequality sharpness: https://arxiv.org/abs/2607.02739
- Official Clay Navier–Stokes problem description: https://www.claymath.org/millennium/navier-stokes-equation/

The broader distinction between useful trial-and-error and unbounded risk is also visible in AI research. AlphaGo Zero learned through self-play, while AlphaProof used generated proof experience and formal verification. Research on safe exploration asks the complementary question: how can a learning system gain experience without making consequential harm the price of every lesson? These examples support the chapter's design principle; they do not imply that a deployed language model possesses human experience or consciousness.

- Silver et al., *Mastering the game of Go without human knowledge*: https://doi.org/10.1038/nature24270
- Hubert et al., *Olympiad-level formal mathematical reasoning with reinforcement learning*: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-025-09833-y
- García and Fernández, *Safe Exploration of State and Action Spaces in Reinforcement Learning*: https://arxiv.org/abs/1402.0560

Part III boundary

This edition does not invent the ending. Part III will own:

- the final procedural result and any remedy or consequence;
- the completed presidential and institutional transition;
- the verified meaning of the new justice-administration correspondence;
- the long-term effect on the Founder's work, home, citizenship and health;
- whether MyScoutee reaches real communities and what those communities teach the product.

